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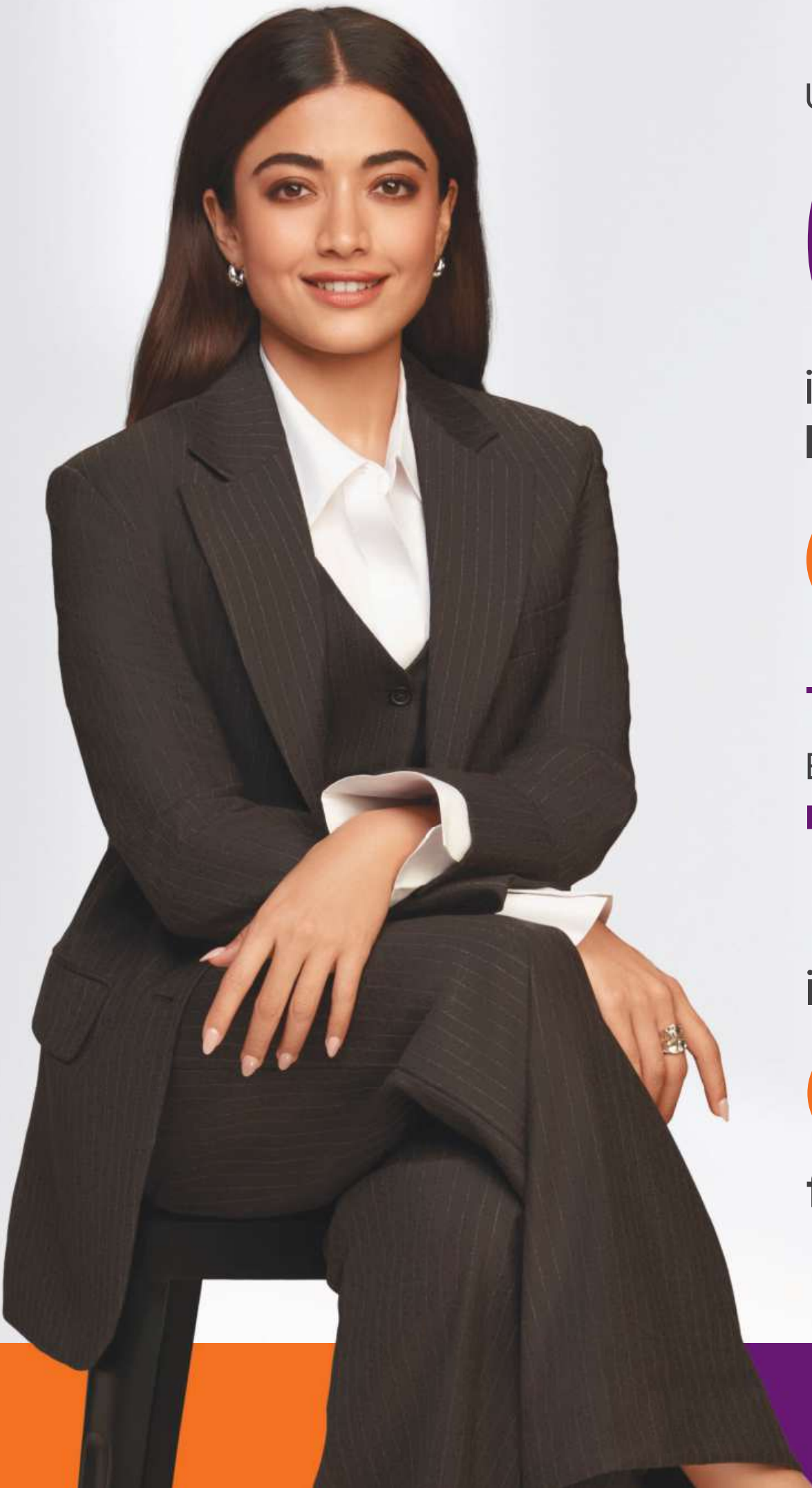


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A one-year-old girl died after falling into a bucket of water while playing at her house in Kavangarai near Puzhal on Monday. The deceased was identified as Yogamaya. She is suspected to have fallen head first into a bucket of water kept in the bathroom. After finding her in the bucket, her family rushed her to a private hospital, where doctors declared her brought dead. The police have registered a case and have launched an investigation.

Chennai Port to push for more non-containerised cargo in bid to boost trade

Officials say the Non-Containerised Cargo Incentive Scheme was launched in June, to overcome the loss incurred due to the impact of the conflict in West Asia, and to increase revenue streams

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Chennai Port, one of the country's major container ports, has been expanding its focus and has now begun initiatives to draw more non-container cargo and encourage new trade through the port.

Officials of Chennai Port Authority said the port, which launched the Non-Containerised Cargo Incentive Scheme (NCCS) in June this year, has gradually begun handling new non-containerised cargo with this initiative. For instance, in recent times, the port has handled 13,208 metric tonnes of pig iron (commonly known as crude iron), 80,000 tonnes of rice, 15,000 tonnes of pulses, and



Major boost: The Non-Containerised Cargo Incentive Scheme will provide the port a competitive advantage and increase the volume of cargo handled by the port. **B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM**

17,000 tonnes of steel
billet.

Due to the impact of the conflict in West Asia, container traffic in the port had taken a hit and registered a dip. To overcome this loss and increase the revenue streams, the port wanted to attract a diverse mix of cargo and the NCCS was launched, sources said. The NCCS will provide the port a competitive advantage and increase the volume of cargo handled

by the port by pulling new cargo.

"The port has nearly 65% of container traffic, 28% is liquid bulk (crude oil and petroleum products), and the rest is dry bulk (products including barytes, gypsum, fertilisers) or break bulk (products, including grains, granite blocks, and steel coils). Over the years, there has been some decline in dry and break bulk, and we wanted to retain exist-

ing firms and attract new firms by incentivising those who are coming to the Chennai Port for handling non-containerised cargo and that is the NCCS scheme," an official said.

Under the NCCS scheme, when a new firm imports or exports through Chennai Port or a firm (which already handles non-containerised cargo through the port) brings incremental cargo, then the wharfage fee (cargo handling charges) gets reduced by up to 80 per cent based on eligibility.

Also, when an existing firm handles 95 per cent of the cargo handled in the last financial year, then they get an additional loyalty bonus equivalent to 10 per cent.

They have been holding meetings with the stakeholders too to draw more non-containerised cargo to the port.

'Most parts of T.N. to receive below-normal rainfall in September'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Most parts of Tamil Nadu are likely to receive below-normal monsoon rainfall in September except for pockets in the northern districts, according to India Meteorological Department (IMD).

In its weather outlook for September, the IMD has said that the monthly rainfall over the country was likely to be below-normal, with expected rainfall at 91% of the long period average.

Some north and interior parts of Tamil Nadu may receive normal to above normal rainfall in September.

It also warned that below-normal rainfall could adversely affect water resources and agriculture, besides increasing risk of heat stress across several regions of the country.

Tamil Nadu has so far recorded an overall rainfall of 16.3 cm, which is 22% below-normal during this Southwest monsoon since June 1.

Many districts, includ-



The IMD warns that below normal rainfall could adversely affect water resources and agriculture in the State.

ing Ariyalur, Nagapattinam, and Thoothukudi recorded significant rainfall deficits, according to the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC).

The IMD attributed moderate to strong El Niño conditions that prevailed over the equatorial Pacific in August as one of the factors for rainfall deficiency across the country.

In September, most parts of Tamil Nadu are expected to experience hot weather with both maximum and minimum temperatures likely to remain above normal, according to the RMC.

Businessman Veeramani allegedly linked to minor girl's death in 2003

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The police are investigating the death of a minor girl, who allegedly ended her life in 2003. Businessman R. Veeramani, 84, also known as Gem Granites Veeramani, has been alleg-

edly linked to the case.

A message sent by one of the accused, Shanthi, to prime accused Veeramani reportedly stated that a child had ended her life because of him. Following this information, City Police Commissioner A. Amalraj formed a special team

to investigate the girl's death.

On Saturday, Veeramani and two others were arrested by the Greater Chennai Police Anti-Vice Squad under the POCSO Act for allegedly sexually exploiting minors.

The police said the case

was registered on October 7, 2025, after a pen drive containing a video of a minor girl being sexually assaulted was handed over to an Anti-Vice Squad inspector. Investigation revealed that the man in the video was Veeramani.

The police said Veera-

mani had rented a house in Teynampet and entrusted its management to Shanthi and her husband, Mahendra Simhan. The investigation revealed that he allegedly brought several minor girls to the house and sexually assaulted them.

Veeramani, Shanthi and

Mahendra Simhan were remanded in judicial custody on Saturday.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416, and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)

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Dr. Ravi K. Sankar

A portrait of a man with a long, grey beard and a black and yellow circular graphic overlay. The man is looking directly at the camera. The graphic consists of a black circle on the left and a yellow circle on the right, both partially overlapping the man's image.

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The inclusive and welcoming spirit of Madras endures

Madras – I still prefer that name to Chennai – is home. I was born here, at Isabel Hospital, and continue to live on Pycrofts Garden, in the only house I have memories of.

Growing up, Madras was gentle and unhurried. Preschool at Women's Christian College, and kindergarten through Class XII at Don Bosco, Egmore, remain very happy memories.

Tennis at the Triangle Tennis Trust in the YMCA, Nandanam, and at Egmore Stadium, and running on the sand at Marina Beach were the highlights of those years.

The people of Madras do not make a fuss and are unpretentious and that is the ci-



Member of Parliament
Karti P. Chidambaram

ty's most enduring trait. The city has changed. It has become more cosmopolitan now, but the infrastructure is yet to gain pace to meet this growth. The spirit of Madras – inclusive and welcoming – endures.
(As told to R. Aishwaryaa)



From the archives: American soprano Leontyne Price

presents a vocal recital at the Museum Theatre on April 10, 1956. This photo and more are on display at *The Hindu* Made of Chennai Archival Photo Exhibit as part of the Madras Month celebrations. The exhibition will be on at *The Hindu* office till September 14 and is open to the public from 10 a.m. to 6.30 p.m. on all days, except Sundays. To visit, register for free at <https://madeofchennai.thehindu.com/>

Timings CHENNAI

TUESDAY, SEP. 01		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:20
RISE	21:12	SET 09:17
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 02		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:19
RISE	22:00	SET 10:14
THURSDAY, SEP. 03		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:19
RISE	22:53	SET 11:15

Chennai Weather

	max	min
Tiruvallur	39	26
Chennai Airport	38	28
Chennai City	37	28

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Chances of light rain and thundershower at few places.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C Day will be very warm. Short spell of light rain and thundershower may occur. Morning will be comfortable. Night also will be comfortable.

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The photograph shows C. N. Annadurai unveiling this statue in T. Nagar in January 1969, in the presence of M. Karunanidhi and M. G. Ramachandran. Whose statue is being unveiled in this photograph?

Answer to yesterday's Photo quiz:

K. Balachander

Yesterday's winners:

1. Srinivasan Govindachari
2. Sujay Koner
3. Vetrivel Thevar



Scan QR code or visit newsth.live/MOC2026PA to take the Photo quiz. Top 3 winners* every day win gift vouchers.

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Supercritical thermal power station to be established in Thoothukudi: Chief Minister

Vijay also announced a ₹1,762-crore project to improve power distribution in Chennai and a T.N. Transmission Improvement Scheme to boost power transmission to major consumption centres

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday announced a Tamil Nadu Transmission Improvement Scheme at a cost of ₹33,066 crore to strengthen power transmission to major consumption centres.

He also said a new supercritical thermal power station would be established in Thoothukudi at a cost of ₹20,800 crore, besides announcing a ₹1,762-crore project to improve power distribution in Chennai.

Making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly, he said that under the Transmission Improvement Scheme, 196 new sub-stations and transmission lines covering 15,000 km would be created. The existing transmission lines would be strengthened.

Contending that no efforts had been made in the last five years to attract investments in thermal and hydel power stations, the Chief Minister said the capacity of the Thoothukudi Thermal Power Station



Vital facility: The capacity of the Thoothukudi Thermal Power Station will be increased. It will have a total installed capacity of 1,600 MW as against the present 1,050 MW. FILE PHOTO

would be increased. The station has five thermal power units, each with a capacity of 210 MW, taking the total installed capacity to 1,050 MW.

He said the 210-MW units would be replaced on the public-private partnership model with two units of 800 MW each.

He also said Chennai's power distribution infrastructure would be improved, as power supply was disrupted during the monsoon and there was a substantial increase in demand during summer. Under the plan, 36 new sub-stations, each with a capac-

ity of 33/11 kV, would be installed, along with new transformers. Damaged and obsolete cables, pillar boxes, and circuit-breakers would also be replaced.

Milk procurement price
Mr. Vijay announced a further increase of ₹3 in the price of milk procured by primary milk producers' cooperative societies, raising the rate to ₹44 a litre. Making a *suo motu* statement, he said the government had increased the procurement price by ₹3 a litre, while the cooperative societies had increased it by ₹1, raising the

price from ₹38 to ₹41. The decision was made considering the increase in input cost and fodder price, he said.

The Chief Minister also announced a Semiconductor and Electronics Manufacturing Park to be set up at Maduramangalam in Kancheepuram district at a cost of ₹175 crore through the State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu.

He said the park would have a global-standard research and development facility to facilitate the establishment of new semiconductor manufacturing units. Besides attracting ₹2,000 crore in investment, it would provide direct and indirect employment to 5,000 people.

The Chief Minister also announced the establishment of the Coimbatore FinTech Hub on the public-private partnership model, at a cost of ₹400 crore, through the Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation (TIDCO); and a Multi-Modal Logistics Hub in the Tiruchirappalli region, based on a project report prepared by TIDCO.

NGT seeks updated report on sewerage connections in areas around Puzhal Lake

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The National Green Tribunal (NGT) has directed the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board (CMWSSB) to submit an updated report on the status of underground sewerage connections on 30 streets around Puzhal Lake, noting that no progress report had been filed since January 2025.

The Southern Bench of the NGT, comprising Justice Pushpa Sathyanarayana and expert member Prashant Gargava, passed the directions while hearing a *suo motu* case based on a report published in *The Hindu* in December 2023 on encroachments and waste pollution along the rear bund of Red Hills Lake.

According to a CMWSSB report filed in January 2025, underground sewerage facilities were unavailable on 30 of the 110 streets in the area, covering 628 premises. The Board had said a Detailed Project Report was being prepared to extend the underground sewerage system (UGSS) to those areas.

The sewage from the existing collection systems was taken to the sewage pumping stations at Iyyankulam, Karukku, and Korattur, before being pumped to the Kodungaiyur treatment plant, the report said. However, the Bench observed that there had been no update on the completion of the UGSS on the 30 streets since January 2025.

The Tamil Nadu Pollu-

tion Control Board (TNPCB), in its report filed in June this year, said it had issued a show-cause notice to the Zonal Officer, Zone VII of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), and the Superintending Engineer, CMWSSB, Zone VII, seeking an explanation on why an environmental compensation of ₹3.45 crore should not be imposed.

The TNPCB had also directed the CMWSSB to ensure that 100% of the households in Kallukuppam, Banu Nagar, Pudur, and Venkatachalam Nagar were connected to a functional UGSS within three months. Any further delay would be treated as wilful negligence and could attract additional environmental penalties, it said.

The Board was also directed to ensure that untreated or partially treated sewage and sullage were not discharged into Puzhal Lake or other waterbodies.

The Bench also directed the GCC to file an updated report, noting that it last filed a report in 2024. The Avadi City Municipal Corporation, which the Bench said was directly involved in the case, had also not filed a report, despite the TNPCB levying an environmental compensation.

The Bench warned that if the Avadi City Municipal Corporation and the Tiruvallur Collector failed to file their respective reports before the next hearing, each report would be accepted only on payment of ₹50,000 as costs.

The matter has been posted for October 5, 2026.

Man arrested for stealing jewellery

CHENNAI: Jalaaluddin, 49, of Washermanpet has been arrested for stealing diamond and gold jewellery, a laptop, and a wristwatch

from the car of actor Varun, 33, using a duplicate key, in Mylapore last month. The police said Mr. Varun had parked his car on the road-

side and went for a wedding. On returning from the event, he found the valuables missing, and lodged a complaint.

THE HINDU

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No. 3252F/Vety/2026 Date: 31/08/2026

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Programmes for September 2026
5th 6 pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam by Kavayaa Kannan 7.30 p.m. S. Sunanda. 15th 5.30 p.m. at Kartik Rajagopal Hall Harikatha - 'Krishna Leela' by Niranjana Vignesh & party 7 pm Samyukta & Samhita (Vocal Duet) & party. 19th 7 pm at TAG MFAC Hall (A/C) Kala Mandir inaugurates Vaelvi by Bombay Chanakya.

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Programme - September 2026 - 1.9.26 - 4.9.26 - 59th Sri Sathguru Gnanananda Sangeet Sammelan Concerts, 5th - Drama - Sathya Sai Creation's Mapillai Ganes in 'Yamini En Kammani' by Ezhichur Aravindan. 6th - Natyarangam Bharathiar Day - 'Kanavu Meipada Vendum' Dancers - Arun Velayudham, Jayalakshmi Katte, Mayura Balagurunathan, Vaishnavi Srinivasan. Guru Saroja Vaidya-

nathan Endowment programme. 9th - Nadasangamam - Vignesh Shankar (Guitar) Nandan Kashyap - (Mridangam, Sarvesh Shankar (Ghatam). 11th - In association with Sruthi Laya Kendra - 81st Birthday Celebrations of Guru Karaikudi Mani - Award function followed by Sandeep Narayanan - (Vocal), L Ramakrishnan - (Violin), Sumesh Narayanan (Mridangam) S.Krishna (Ghatam). Mini Hall 12th - 14th - Daily at 6.30 pm - Lecture - "Thyagaraja Leelaigal" by Madusudan Kalaichelvan. 15th - Drama - In association with Sruthi Laya Kendra - Guru Surajandana Day - 'Legally Yours' 'Kudumbadag' by Satish Chandrasekaran. 18th - Natyarangam - Bharathanatyam - 6pm - Sandhya Udupa (Disciple of Indira Kidambi) 7.30 pm - Pavithra Lingendra (Kalakshetra). 26th - In association with Papanasam Sivan Rasikar Sangam - Papanasam Sivan Day - 5 pm - Raghu Vellal & party. 5 pm - 'Kapaleeshwarar Pancharatanam' - Group singing by Vidwans & Vidhushis. 7.15 pm - Dance Drama - 'Andal Charitham' (Composed by Papanasam Sivan) by students of Kalakshetra.

Narada Gana Sabha Trust
Ph: 24993201
Today Mini Hall (Swami Hari-dhosh Giri Hall) - 39th Sri Sadguru Gnanananda Sangeetha Sammelan 3 pm - Kalakad R Thyagarajan & Kalakad R Srinivasan, R.Raghu, M.S. Venkatasubramanian, Trichy Dr. K. Murali. 4.30 pm - Savitha Sreeram, Karaikkal S Venkatasubramanian, Burra Sriram, Harihara Subramanian. 6 pm - Senkottai Sri Hari Hara Subramaniam, V.L.Kumar, J Vaidyanathan, Madipakkam A Murali. 7.30 pm - Nagai R Muralidharan & Dr. G. Badrinarayana - Violin Duet, Srimushnam V Raja Rao, N Guruprasad. All are welcome.

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11.09.2026 Fri - 6:15 pm
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(by disciples of the Late Smt.Neela Ramgopal)
Srikrishnan, Dilip Simha, Ramesh Kottakota, Jagdish AKSreelakshmi Bhat - Violin
Sarvajit Krishna - Mridangam
Dummies Drama Feast
19.09.2026 Sat 7pm - Thanimal
20.09.2026 Sun 5pm - Payanam
7pm - Aradhanai Written and Directed by Sreevathson.V.
28.09.2026 Mon - 6:15 pm
Lec Dem by Madhusudhan Kalaiselvan & B Sargurunathan

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CMDA shelves plan to develop township in Kancheepuram

With the dropping of the project, residents of areas such as Tiruvallur, Minjur have raised concern over development of townships in their areas

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority (CMDA) has scrapped the proposed development of a new township at Kancheepuram.

In a Government Order (G.O.), the State government rescinded the preparation of a ‘New Town Development Plan for Kancheepuram New Town’ and ‘Detailed Development and Heritage Revitalisation Plan’, issued through a government gazette dated February 22, 2023. A senior CMDA official confirmed the order issued by R. Kirosh Kumar, Principal Secretary of the Housing and Urban Development Department on shelving the project.

Review meeting

Citing the G.O., he said that at the review meeting held by the Additional Chief Secretary of the Housing and Urban Development Department on April 29, 2025, the Directorate of Town and Country Planning team had announced that they had prepared a Master Plan for Kancheepuram local planning area (155.25 sq.km), with help from the School of Architecture and Planning of Anna University under the



Urbanisation push: The CMDA had also been planning to develop five other satellite townships, including ones in Thirumazhisai and Mamallapuram, through the land pooling concept. R. RAGU

AMRUT scheme, and submitted the draft Master Plan for the consent of the CMDA member secretary.

C.V.M.P. Ezhilaraman, former MLA of Kancheepuram constituency, said it was during the previous DMK regime the municipality was upgraded into a corporation.

The new township was announced to take the town forward as it would have helped in proper planning.

J. Ranganathan, a long-time resident of Kancheepuram, said the town, known for its silk saris and having several historical temples, was already facing heavy vehicular congestion in addition to encroachments. There is no proper planning to widen arterial roads and proper traffic management. The

scrapping of the township project only goes to show the failure of the State government to showcase this town as a major tourist destination located close to the city.

Triggering uncertainty

The shelving of the proposed development of the new township has created doubts among the residents of Chengalpattu, Mamallapuram, Minjur, Tiruvallur, and Thirumazhisai, where townships were also planned.

The CMDA had planned to develop six satellite townships through the land pooling concept.

The CMDA had also appointed consultants for preparing reports for Thirumazhisai, Chengalpattu, Kancheepuram, and Mamallapuram.

FQL scam: MLM-cum-crypto trading fraud cases shifted to Economic Offences Wing

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Economic Offences Wing (EOW) will now investigate a multi-level marketing (MLM)-cum-cryptocurrency trading fraud operated under the names ‘FQL Investment Trading’, ‘FQL Exchange App’, and ‘VG Investment Group Syndicate’ across Madurai, Virudhunagar, Dindigul, and Sivaganga districts over the past seven months. Hundreds of residents had recently complained of being duped by the ponzi scheme.

Agents associated with the scheme allegedly induced members of the public to invest money by promising abnormally high daily returns and claiming that their investments could be doubled within 40-45 days through cryptocurrency trading.

Director-General of Police/Head of Police Force (DGP/HoPF) Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal said several petitions and complaints had been received from alleged victims across the four districts. Based on information about the functioning of the scheme, the Madurai district police conducted preliminary inquiries with agents and investors to ascertain the nature and operations of the purported cryptocurrency trading platform.

Following specific complaints and preliminary verification, six cases have, so far, been registered in connection with the alleged fraud – three in Madurai district and one each in Dindigul, Virudhunagar, and Sivaganga districts. Investigation into the cases is under way. So far, 17 accused persons have been arrested and remanded in judicial custody, while 13 bank accounts linked to

the accused have been frozen as part of the investigation.

The DGP said preliminary investigation indicated that local agents allegedly collected investments from the public through cash and G-Pay/UPI transactions.

A portion of the funds was allegedly converted into Tether (USDT) and transferred to FQL/VG wallets. Subsequently, investors reportedly faced difficulties in withdrawing their money, with balances becoming inaccessible and additional payments being demanded. The application was later shut down, leaving investors unable to access their purported balances.

The State police decided to transfer the cases for a detailed investigation, said Mr. Aggarwal while ordering the transfer of all six cases to the EOW.

Gym instructor held for assaulting woman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 30-year-old gym instructor was arrested by M.K.B. Nagar police for allegedly assaulting and threatening to kill his 28-year-old relative.

The accused was identified as Sudhakar, 30, of Ne-

taji Nagar in Tondiarpet. According to the police, the woman, who works at a private company, had been in a relationship with Sudhakar. Following a dispute, the woman stopped communicating with him. Sudhakar allegedly abused and assaulted her on the way from work.

APPOINTMENT



V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority
General Administration Department, Tuticorin
(An Autonomous Body under MoPSW, GoI)



No.GAD-EST10ESTC(EST)/31/2024-GAD(6485)/D. Date:01.09.2026

V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority invites applications for filling up the following post on Deputation Basis from eligible officers of Government /Semi Government /Public Sector undertaking/ Autonomous bodies (Other than Major Port Authorities):-

Sl. No.	Class	Name of the post	Scale of Pay (In ₹)
1.	Class – I	Chief Engineer	100000-260000

For, details regarding experience, educational qualifications, etc., visit VOC Port's website at www.vocport.gov.in (careers). Last date for the receipt of applications is 30.09.2026.

Sd/-
Secretary



KARNATAKA STATE POLICE HOUSING AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
#59, Richmond Road (Gen K.S. Thimmaiah Road),
Bengaluru-25. Ph : 080-25584103
Email: eecontractkspshc@gmail.com Website: www.kspshc.org

No. EE/KSPH&IDCL/CNT/TND/02/2026-27/09/120 Date : 31.08.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

KSPH & IDCL invites online tender as per KTPP 2000 Act & as per Standard Tender Document through KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> for the below works.

Sl. No.	Name of the works
1	Construction of PC Quarters under Police Gruha - 2025 Phase - VI at Various Locations in Karnataka.

Interested eligible Contractors may participate in the tendering process. The details such as Tender Fee, EMD, Tender documents etc., are available on KPPP from **03.09.2026 onwards** "KSPH & IDCL reserves the right to accept or reject any or all Bid without assigning any reasons".
Note : Henceforth any changes / modifications in the tender will be updated only on KPPP.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer-Contracts

DIPR/CP/NC/2498/2026-27

10 persons nabbed for riding bikes dangerously

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The police caught 10 persons, including six juveniles, for allegedly riding two-wheelers at high speed and performing dangerous stunts on 100 Feet Road near the Metro Rail station in Arumbakam on Sunday.

The arrested persons were Adithya, 23, Senthamizhselvan, 20, Rahul, 27, and Ajay Kumar, 23. The juveniles were sent to an observation home. Five two-wheelers were seized.

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Engineer (CON)/II/Garden Reach, Kolkata-700043 invites e-tender for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website www.ireps.gov.in. The tender will be closed at 12:00 hrs. on due date: **e-Tender Notice No.: 4652-GRC-CE-C-II-29-2026; Brief Description of Works** : Construction of doubling of track work including earthwork, blanketing, minor bridges, LC work and other miscellaneous works for 25T Indian Railway Standard Loading, execution of indoor & outdoor S&T works, installation and commissioning of 2x25 KV overhead equipment (OHE) for traction and power supply in connection with the Adra-Sanka-Rukni doubling project of Adra Division, South Eastern Railway on Engineering, Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode. **Pre Bid Meeting** : Date: 10.09.2026, Time: 12:00 hrs.; **Venue**: Office of the Chief Administrative Officer (Con), 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043. **Closing Date** : by 12:00 hrs. (IST) on 09.10.2026; **Approx. Cost**: ₹ 147.12 Crore, **Bid Security**: ₹ 2,94,23,300.00; **Period of Completion**: 24 months; Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB**: "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders." (PR-687)



Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010
Website : <https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in>, e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :-JCECEB/46/26- 75 ,Ranchi/Dated: 31/08/2026

Indicative information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S. course

PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 27.08.2026 regarding NEET-UG Schedule – 2026 for Round-2 of State Counselling, the Board will hold 2nd (Second) Round of Online Counselling for **vacant 60% seats earmarked for qualified students from across the country (All India Quota) & 15 % seats earmarked for NRI supported students (NRI Quota) in M.B.B.S. course** in Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Palamu; Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Seraikela-Kharsawan; Sido Kanhu Medical College & Hospital, Dumka and Birsa Institute of Medical Sciences & Research Khunti.

The Detailed information in regards with above is available in the Press Communique titled "**Important Information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S., B.D.S. & B.H.M.S. Courses**" uploaded under the "**Important Notice**" section on the Board's website: <http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in>

By the order of Controller of Examination
Sd/-
(Officer on Special Duty)

PR 388714 Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board(26-27)#D



Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board
Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010
Website : <https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in>, e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :-JCECEB/46/26- 74 ,Ranchi/Dated: 31/08/2026

Indicative information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to B.D.S. course

PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 27.08.2026 regarding NEET-UG Schedule – 2026 for Round-2 of State Counselling, the Board will hold 2nd (Second) Round of Online Counselling for **vacant 60% seats earmarked for qualified students from across the country (All India Quota) & 15 % seats earmarked for NRI supported students (NRI Quota) in B.D.S. course** in Vananchal Dental College and Hospital, Garhwa under Babu Dinesh Singh University, Garhwa.

The Detailed information in regards with above is available in the Press Communique titled "**Important Information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S., B.D.S. & B.H.M.S. Courses**" uploaded under the "**Important Notice**" section on the Board's website: <http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in>

By the order of Controller of Examination
Sd/-
(Officer on Special Duty)

PR 388713Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board (26-27)#D

NAGPUR METROPOLITAN REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Station Road, Kingsway, Sadar, Nagpur-440001.

e-TENDER NOTICE No. 12/2026-27
www.mahatenders.gov.in

Sealed Percentage Rate/Item Rate e-tenders are invited from Non-Registered / Registered Contractors with N.M.R.D.A./ N.I.T./P.W.D. / N.M.C. or other Govt. Dept. as per eligibility criteria for **One** work. The details of work will be uploaded on tender website i.e. www.mahatenders.gov.in

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Amount of Work / E.M.D. in Rs.	Eligibility / Tender Cost in Rs.	Time Limit in Months	Division
1	Appointment of Consultant for preparation of Feasibility Study Report, Detailed Project Report and Providing Transaction Advisory Services for Golden Ring Road in Nagpur, Maharashtra State.	<u>As Per Tender Document</u> 25,00,000/-	<u>As Per Tender Document</u> 25,000/-	06	NMRDA

Money :- E.M.D. is to be paid by online only. **Plans & Estimates** :- Available in the Technical Section, Head Office, Sadar, Nagpur. **Tender Forms** :- From **02.00 P.M.** on Date **03.09.2026** up to **2.00 P.M.** on Date **18.09.2026** on www.mahatenders.gov.in **Receipt / Submission** :- From **02.00 P.M.** on Date **03.09.2026** up to **2.00 P.M.** on Date **18.09.2026** on www.mahatenders.gov.in. **Pre-Bid Meeting** :- On **4.00 P.M.** on Date **07.09.2026** in the office of S.E., NMRDA, Station Road, NMRDA, Head Office, Sadar, Nagpur. **Opening** :- At N.M.R.D.A. Office on Date **21.09.2026** at 2.00 P.M. or as decided by N.M.R.D.A.

-sd- Superintending Engineer,
Advt. No. : S.E.(NMRDA)/34/2026-27 Dated : 31.08.2026 Nagpur Metropolitan Region Development Authority

GET YOUR CKYC NUMBER, IT HELPS IN OPENING ACCOUNT AND RE-KYC



How it works:

- Banks capture and upload customers' KYC information onto the Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCR)
- A 14-digit number is assigned to the customer
- This 14-digit number can be used by other financial institutions to retrieve the customer's existing KYC records for opening an account and Re-KYC



To get your CKYC number:
Contact your Bank **OR** Give a missed call on 7799022129 **OR** Visit <https://ckycindia.in>



For more information, visit <https://rbikehtahai.rbi.org.in/CKYCR>
Official WhatsApp Nos. 99990 41935 / 99309 91935



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INBRIEF



Congress floor leader allotted front-row seat in Assembly

Colachel MLA Tharahai Cuthbert of the Congress, who had been elected as the leader of the party in the Assembly, was allotted a seat in the front row, along with the leaders of other Opposition parties. When the Colachel MLA raised a question from the front row on Monday, DMK legislator and whip E.V. Velu asked Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar to consider their request for allotting front-row seats to senior members, including M.H. Jawahirullah and Thameemun Ansari. The Speaker said that though he had taken the decision based on the symbols on which the members had contested in the election, he would consider Mr. Velu's request and announce his decision at an appropriate time.



'220 T.N. pilgrims in Nepal are safe, 84 others untraceable'

Public Works Minister Aadhav Arjuna on Monday said 220 pilgrims from Tamil Nadu, who were in Nepal when flash floods struck, were safe, while 84 others could not be traced. The Minister told the Assembly that the government was in touch with the family members of those who could not be traced. "We collected details from the commanding system of the External Affairs Ministry. We requested the Ministry to establish contact with the governments in Tibet and China, as they could have gone there," the Minister said. He said 21 persons had already reached Tamil Nadu, and the government had made arrangements for family members who wanted to travel to Nepal. He said the State government was working closely with the Centre and the Nepal government to rescue the pilgrims from Tamil Nadu, and help centres were functioning round the clock.



Manickam Tagore, Praveen Chakravarty meet Vijay

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president B. Manickam Tagore and Member of Parliament in the Rajya Sabha Praveen Chakravarty met Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat on Monday. Sources in the Congress said that the party leaders discussed the delimitation exercise and The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, and the happenings in the recent parliamentary session with the Chief Minister. The sources added that there was no discussion on the recent controversy over the positioning of Mr. Vijay as a prime ministerial candidate in the northern parts of the country.

TVK and DMK fight it out in the Assembly over collection of extra ₹10 a liquor bottle

The additional sum is the result of years of underpaying shop workers and non-allocation of funds for upkeep of Tasmac shops, says Minister K. Vignesh. He announces a wage hike for Tasmac staff

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Prohibition and Excise K. Vignesh said on Monday that the "extra ₹10" collected at Tasmac liquor shops was the result of years of underpaying the shop workers and non-allocation of funds for paying electricity bills or for the upkeep of the outlets. Responding to Deputy Leader of the Opposition K.N. Nehru of the DMK, who asked why the extra charge of ₹10 per bottle was still being collected, Mr. Vignesh said, "The problem at Tasmac is that the consumers don't decide which liquor brands will be sold at the outlets, but politicians do."

The Minister, who presented the demand for grants for his departments, said, "When we tried to stop the staff from collecting the extra charge, we found that it cost them at least ₹10,000 a month to keep the shop running. Those who are earning ₹11,000 a month cannot do this. Who made them collect the extra ₹10? What did you [the previous DMK government] do to stop this practice? The workers are telling me that they were collecting only ₹5, but it was the officials who



The Tamil Nadu Assembly session under way on Monday. PTI

made them collect more. It is the DMK that made them do it."

Mr. Nehru said it was unfair to accuse the DMK of corruption when the Minister himself admitted in the Assembly that the money was collected for the upkeep of the stores.

Law Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar said, "The issue of corruption over ₹10 came to the fore after 10% [₹10] was fixed...This means 10% of the ₹50,000 crore, and ₹5,000 crore is not a small amount."

DMK MLA and former Minister E.V. Velu said attempts were being made to brand the DMK corrupt.

PMK floor leader Sowmiya Anbumani appealed to the government to bring in prohibition, and appreciated the government for the establishment of 20 new POCSO Act courts to speed up trial.

Mr. Vignesh said an e-Kalaal application would be created at a cost of ₹1.69 crore. It would cover FL 2, FL 3, FL 3A, and FL 3AA licence cancellation, transfer, renewal, and foreign liquor import licensing, he added.

After rolling out a 25% increase in wages in July, Mr. Vignesh announced another wage hike for the Tasmac workers who have been in service for the last 23 years, with effect from September 1.

"From September 1,

2026, supervisors will be paid ₹33,023, salesman will be paid ₹30,284, and assistant salesman will be paid ₹28,680. The pay increase will cost the exchequer ₹486.90 crore. The workers will receive ₹20,000 in festival advance and an annual uniform allowance of ₹6,000. Towards maintenance, the

shops in the municipal corporations will get ₹5,000, those in the municipalities will get ₹4,000, and those in rural areas will get ₹3,000," he said.

The cost of FL 2 licence had been increased from ₹15 lakh to ₹30 lakh, and this increase would likely bring in a revenue of ₹37.75 crore, he said.

"When the workers sought a wage hike [in the past], those who were running the department told them that they had already been collecting more per bottle. Since officials allowed them to collect more, the workers found it convenient to do so. During the COVID-19 pandemic, when physical distancing had to be maintained and PPE kits had to be bought, the additional cost of a bottle increased. We need to look at the underlying causes. The workers also committed mistakes, and they were instigated to do so," he said.

He said an additional privilege fee of ₹90, ₹40, and ₹20 had been levied on a box of Indian Made Foreign Liquor, and a case of beer and wine, respectively. This levy would bring in an additional revenue of ₹209.75 crore, he added. He warned the workers that charging extra would not be tolerated.

Speaker calls for self-restraint among Assembly members

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar on Monday made a strong case for self-restraint and self-regulation among members of the House as its proceedings were being broadcast live.

"The people are ready to question the behaviour of the members, and wonder what is wrong in exposing those who denigrate the dignity of the House. There will be no problem if members keep in mind the dignity of the House, their own dignity, and the dignity of the voters who elected them," he said, recalling a conversation he had with a group of youngsters in Dindigul.

Mr. Prabhakar said the youngsters had no political background, but had developed an interest in politics and nurtured the idea of entering public life. One of them wanted to know whether members could conduct themselves in a manner that prevents them from making remarks that would have to be expunged, he said.

"They asked me whether I could tell them about self-restraint. The people are closely watching the proceedings and what is being spoken in the House," he said, adding that he would take a decision on the issue after consulting members.

Earlier, DMK deputy leader K.N. Nehru brought

The people are ready to question the behaviour of the members, says J.C.D. Prabhakar

to the Speaker's notice the use of expunged remarks on social media, and reminded him of the two notices he had submitted in connection with the issue.

The Speaker said elections to various committees, including the Privileges Committee, would be conducted next week, and the issues would be referred to the committee.

Mr. Prabhakar said he would not allow members to raise issues that had not been brought to his notice in the morning before the session began. He said he allowed it when there was no Question Hour and calling attention motion.

"The government is announcing new schemes. When an issue is mentioned, the people might think that the member effectively raised the issue, but the Minister was unable to give an answer. Such wrong impression should not be allowed to form in the minds of the people, and I cannot cause embarrassment to the government," he said.

He requested Ministers and their departments to ensure that answers to queries raised by members were made available quickly.

9 seed storage warehouses to be set up at a cost of ₹11.64 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister R. Vinoth on Monday announced in the Assembly a slew of measures, including the establishment of nine seed storage warehouses in seven districts at a cost of ₹11.64 crore.

The warehouses will come up at Kaattuthottam and Pattukkottai in Thanjavur district, Nagamangalam in Mayiladuthurai, Velalaviduthi in Pudukkottai, Papparpatti in Dharmapuri, Danishpet in Salem, Madathukulam in Tiruppur, and Kanchikudigadu and Keerandhi in Tiruvavur. The facilities are intended to preserve the quality, germination capacity, and vigour of seeds procured from farmers.

The Minister also announced four new Sub-Agricultural Extension Centre buildings with seed storage facilities at Enkan in Tiruvavur, Indur in Dharmapuri, Neelakanda-



R. Vinoth

rayapettai in Ranipet, and Karumandampalayam in Erode at a cost of ₹2.85 crore. The centres are intended to enable farmers to access good quality agricultural inputs close to their villages.

Several of the announcements focused on upgrading infrastructure and machinery in cooperative sugar mills. Modern swing-type fibrizor units with motors will be installed at the Kallakurichi-1 and Tiruthani cooperative sugar mills at a total cost of ₹8.58 crore. The units, with an extraction efficiency of more than 85%, are expected to improve sugar recovery and reduce sugar loss.

The State will also provide 28,500 beekeeping boxes and 2,850 honey extraction equipment units to farmers at a cost of ₹6.84 crore, with the objective of promoting beekeeping as an additional source of income and improving pollination and crop yields.

For farmer producer organisations (FPOs), ₹50 lakh will be provided as a 50% subsidy, capped at ₹10 lakh per vehicle, to enable five FPOs to purchase refrigerated cargo vehicles. The measure is intended to help them transport aggregated produce to markets at the appropriate time, and reduce dependence on intermediaries.

The State will also seek GI tags for 10 agricultural products, including Kancheepuram pari milagai, Chidambaram black gram, Tiruvaiyaru banana leaf, Cuddalore vetiver, Manappara brinjal, Ooty garlic, and Jawadhu sesame, with ₹30 lakh earmarked for the purpose.

T.N. government to formulate plan to prevent drug abuse

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government will formulate a State-level drug abuse prevention action plan, Minister for Social Welfare and Women Empowerment K. Jegadeshwari said in the Assembly on Monday.

"It will be implemented at a cost ₹3.80 crore to prevent drug abuse among children and youth and provide rehabilitation and social integration support to the victims," she said.

New Anganwadis

Announcing measures for childcare and early childhood development, the Minister said the government would establish 300 new Anganwadis at a cost of ₹51 crore in urban areas. Select Anganwadis would be reconstructed at a cost of ₹12.96 crore. A sum of ₹5.20 crore had been allocated for developing learning materials in Tamil and

English for Anganwadi children in 50 blocks as a pilot project.

For senior citizens, Ms. Jegadeshwari said a retirement residential facility with quality services would be established on a public-private partnership model at an estimated cost of ₹14.50 crore.

"To help in the rehabilitation and care of senior citizens at old age homes, physiotherapy and palliative care services will be provided at a cost of ₹5.5 crore per year," she said.

Presenting the demand for grants for the Differently Aabled Welfare Department, Ms. Jegadeshwari said a petrol-powered scooter or battery-powered device would be given to persons with dwarfism at a cost of ₹4 crore.

Further, 10 additional homes for the persons with mental illness would be established through NGOs with an allocation of ₹1.82 crore.

CM will soon announce a Sports City, says Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Public Works Minister Aadhav Arjuna on Monday told the Assembly that Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay would soon make an announcement on a proposed Sports City with facilities of international standards.

'Being restructured'

"It will accommodate 46 forms of sport, and the work will begin within six months of the Chief Minister making the announcement," he said, responding to Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin, who asked about the Sports City announced during the previous DMK government.

Mr. Arjuna, who also holds the Sports Development portfolio, said that there was no plan to drop the Sports City project, and that it was only being restructured.

Thoppu Venkatachalam, ex-Erode Central district secretary of the DMK, quits party

The Hindu Bureau
ERODE

Former DMK Erode Central district secretary N.D. Venkatachalam, alias Thoppu Venkatachalam, announced his decision to quit the party on Monday, days after he was removed from the post.

Addressing reporters at Perundurai, Mr. Venkatachalam, who was a Minister in the AIADMK government, said he would write to the DMK leadership, conveying his decision to



Thoppu Venkatachalam

resign from the party's primary membership. "I thank the party leadership for giving me the post of Erode Central district se-

cretary. I am leaving the DMK as I can no longer continue in the party owing to the anguish caused by my bitter experiences," he said.

Mr. Venkatachalam said he had no plans, for now, to join any other party. He said he had no complaints against former Minister S. Muthusamy, a local DMK strongman.

Expressing concern over the lack of development in the Perundurai constituency, he said there were shortcomings in projects

such as the Perundurai-Kodiveri Combined Water Supply Scheme and Athikadavu-Avinashi scheme.

Mr. Venkatachalam said DMK president M.K. Stalin had shown immense affection for him, and he continued to have great respect for Mr. Stalin.

In the 2026 election, Mr. Venkatachalam contested from Perundurai as the DMK candidate and polled 60,609 votes, losing to AIADMK candidate S. Jayakumar, who later joined the TVK.

The Hindu Bureau
SALEM

Chopped body parts of a woman were found in two overhead water tanks of a house, and on the terrace of an adjacent building in Arisipalayam in Salem district in the early hours of Monday.

The police have launched an investigation to trace the identity of the victim.

According to the police, Ramesh, 62, a resident of Gunabalan Ramasamy

The police have launched an investigation to trace the identity of the victim

Street in Arisipalayam, had left for Kumbakonam and Thanjavur with his family two days ago. In the early hours of Monday, the family returned home and noticed a foul odour on opening the water tap. When Mr. Ramesh checked the overhead wa-

ter tanks in the terrace, he found two gunny bags containing the body parts and immediately alerted the police.

The police retrieved the gunny bags and found that a few body parts were missing. They found another gunny bag with the remaining body parts on the terrace of a neighbouring house. The police sent the three gunny bags to the Salem Government Hospital for a postmortem. Forensic experts lifted fingerprints from the spot, and

sniffer dogs were pressed into service.

The Pallapatti police registered a case and, on suspicion, took three persons in the locality, including a college student, for questioning.

Police sources said the name Ganapathi was tattooed on the deceased's hand. The age of the deceased might be 30-40, they added.

The police were scrutinising CCTV footage to identify the accused, the sources said.

Keralam CM orders SIT to probe Messi event row

G. Anand
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on Monday directed the Home Department to constitute a special investigation team (SIT) for a anti-corruption and suspected tax fraud inquiry into the previous Left Democratic Front (LDF) government's endeavour to bring the 2021 FIFA World Cup-winning Argentina team and its captain, Lionel Messi, for a friendly exhibition match at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Kochi in August 2025.

Officials told *The Hindu* that Mr. Satheesan sent a letter to Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala flagging the findings of the Finance department's recently concluded inquiry into the suspected GST evasion on foreign remittances made by the sponsor, a news broadcasting company, ostensibly to secure the presence of Messi and his famed team.

According to them, the inquiry found that the sponsoring firm had wire transferred ₹126 crore to a foreign entity through banking channels in 2025. It concluded that the transaction triggered a service tax obligation of ₹22.68 crore to the exchequer.

Officials said Mr. Satheesan also ordered the Home Department to probe the suspected conspiracy to defraud the treasury. The Finance department inquiry faulted GST officials for putting the brakes on holding the sponsor to account for suspected tax evasion.

CWMA water-release order being enforced: Karnataka

State says it is implementing the order to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs of Cauvery water to T.N.; Karnataka's present compliance does not address accumulated shortfall, T.N. tells Supreme Court

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Karnataka government on Monday told the Supreme Court that it was complying with the Cauvery Water Management Authority's (CWMA) direction to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs of water to Tamil Nadu.

On August 25, the CWMA had upheld the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee's (CWRC) recommendation directing Karnataka to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs to Tamil Nadu for 15 days.

Appearing for Karnataka, senior advocate Shyam Divan said the State had released 9,888 cusecs on August 30, against the re-



Water shortage: A view of the dried Cauvery river at Tiruchi district of Tamil Nadu on August 29. M. MOORTHY

quired 9,000 cusecs, while the flow had crossed 11,000 cusecs by Monday morning. "We have released an excess amount as of 8 a.m. this morning," Mr. Divan said, adding that Karnataka would endeavour to maintain the required flow of 9,000

cusecs. In an application filed on Sunday, Tamil Nadu had sought a direction to Karnataka to release 17,604 tmc ft of water, which it claimed was the balance due as of August 27 under the pro-rata formula.

On Monday, senior ad-

vocate C.S. Vaidyanathan, appearing for Tamil Nadu, contended that Karnataka's present compliance with the 9,000-cusec requirement did not address the accumulated shortfall in earlier releases.

The Bench pointed out that if Tamil Nadu sought water over and above what the CWMA had directed, the authority's decision would have to be challenged before the appropriate forum.

Taking note of the fact that the issue was already under consideration by the statutory authorities, the Bench observed that the CWRC was meeting every 15 days.

The court posted the matter for further hearing on September 15.

Karnataka HC quashes land acquisition for KHB project

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a major setback to the State government, the High Court of Karnataka has quashed the acquisition of 1,938 acres of land for the Karnataka Housing Board's (KHB) ambitious Suryanagar 4th phase residential layout project. The court held that the land is part of areas proposed to be declared as eco-sensitive zone (ESZ) of the Bannerghatta National Park (BNP) besides abutting elephant corridors.

A Division Bench comprising Justice D.K. Singh and Justice H. Shanthi Bhushan passed the order on August 29 while setting aside a single judge's January 2025 verdict.

The single judge had allowed the acquisition of agricultural land on the condition that the KHB should obtain necessary clearances from the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

"Not only for human..." "Housing is not the only requirement for human existence. Ecology, wildlife, forest, water streams etc., all are equally important for human existence. We are, therefore, of the view that since the project in question itself falls within the BNP's proposed ESZ of 268.96 sq. km., the whole project is misconceived and would have irreversible ecological, environmental and wildlife related consequences," the Bench observed.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Sikkim, Odisha and Chhattisgarh. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.7	25.8	Kurnool	0.2	32.3	25.7
Ahmedabad	—	33.3	26.7	Lucknow	0.1	31.8	27.5
Aizawl	27	31.4	24.6	Madurai	—	40.2	26.1
Bengaluru	0.3	28.5	20.0	Mangaluru	29	30.2	23.4
Bhopal	—	28.5	23.0	Mumbai	0.3	31.9	26.8
Bhubaneswar	20.1	30.6	24.6	Mysuru	—	30.2	20.0
Chandigarh	—	35.0	26.0	New Delhi	—	35.2	27.7
Chennai	8.2	36.5	25.4	Patna	8	33.4	27.8
Coimbatore	—	33.8	22.2	Port Blair	—	31	30.6
Dehradun	32.6	30.6	23.3	Prayagraj	54.5	28.0	25.8
Gangtok	21	23.3	18.4	Puducherry	—	38.4	27.8
Goa	1	31.8	25.8	Pune	—	30.6	22.0
Guwahati	10.7	32.5	25.8	Raipur	66	27.5	23.2
Hubballi	—	27.0	21.0	Ranchi	5	25.8	23.0
Hyderabad	3.8	30.0	22.8	Shillong	25	27.4	18.7
Imphal	19.2	25.2	22.1	Shimla	60	22.2	16.5
Jaipur	—	33.4	25.6	Srinagar	—	33.0	19.6
Kochi	0.4	30.4	26.0	Thiruvananthapuram	3.6	31.6	24.7
Kohima	1	23.0	19.6	Tiruchirappalli	—	38.9	27.0
Kolkata	2.4	31.5	27.5	Vijayawada	1	34.0	25.2
Kozhikode	1.6	33.4	25.6	Visakhapatnam	—	33.4	28.2

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITY	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	17	39	57	50	79	■	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Baraut, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 239
Bengaluru	22	17	63	92	113	■	indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Korba, Chhattisgarh recorded a healthy AQI score of 19
Chennai	5	14	52	46	60	■	
Delhi	27	43	43	83	235	■	
Hyderabad	12	13	38	39	58	■	
Kolkata	6	34	31	34	33	■	
Lucknow	5	25	36	39	66	■	
Mumbai	6	34	42	14	36	■	
Pune	14	13	69	26	80	■	
Visakhapatnam	11	62	8	47	82	■	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Man held for rape, murder of nurse

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The Hyderabad Police arrested a 34-year-old man in connection with the alleged rape and murder of a 21-year-old nurse at Thukkuguda.

The accused was identified as Md. Sanaullah, a native of Begusarai district in Bihar who worked as a bike mechanic and stayed at a shop near the hospital, where the victim worked. According to the police, the woman's aunt lodged a

complaint on August 29 after the victim's friend informed her that the woman had not come out of her room since morning. The woman was found dead with bleeding injuries on her face.

The police said their investigation, supported by technical evidence and specific information, led them to Sanaullah, who was apprehended on the evening of Sunday, within 30 hours of receiving the complaint.

According to the police,

Sanaullah had come to Hyderabad in 2023. He moved to Thukkuguda and started working at a bike mechanic shop.

The police said he kept a track of the woman's movements from the shop about a month before the incident.

'Came through window' On August 29, he allegedly entered the woman's room through a window around 12.30 a.m. When the woman woke up and raised an alarm, he allegedly co-

vered her mouth and held her by the throat. During the struggle, she allegedly bit his little finger on the left hand and scratched his throat and chest.

The police said Sanaullah then strangled her before sexually assaulting her. He allegedly closed the window and left the place.

A mobile phone and clothes of the accused were seized. Scientific, technical and other corroborative evidence was being collected and analysed as part of the probe.

Uttar Pradesh Medical Supplies Corporation Limited
(A Govt. of Uttar Pradesh Undertaking)
GSTIN: 09AACCU2250P1ZZ; CIN: U05510UP2018SGC102425

Tender Ref. No.: GEM/2026/B/7943436 Date: 27-08-2026

Tender Notice Invitation

Uttar Pradesh Medical Supplies Corporation Limited, Lucknow invites tenders on GeM Portal from eligible and qualified Manufacturer/Importer/Authorized Agent for supply of Brain Stem Evoked Response Audiometer with ASSR with OAE. The schedules of Tendering activities are as here under:

S.N.	Activity	Date & Time
1.	Tender Reference No.	GEM/2026/B/7943436
2.	Commencement of Downloading of Tender Document	27-08-2026
3.	Date & Time of Pre-Bid Meeting	04/09/2026 at 4:00 PM in Conference Hall of UPMSCL, Lucknow.
4.	Last Date & Submission of Online Bids	17/09/2026 up to 03:00 PM.
5.	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	17/09/2026 at 03:30 PM
6.	Date of Completion of Examination of Technical Bid	To be declared on GeM Portal
7.	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid	To be declared on GeM Portal
8.	Date of Completion of Examination of Financial Bid	To be declared on GeM Portal

The details of tender notice are given on GeM Portal & UPMSCL website www.upmscl.in. Kindly check GeM Portal & UPMSCL website for any detail & updates.

Managing Director, UPMSCL

Department of Medical Health & Family Welfare, Uttar Pradesh

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
KANUPUR IRRIGATION PROJECT
AT/PO-BASUDEVPUR, DIST-KEONJHAR, ODISHA, PIN-758047
e-mail: ccekipbbur@gmail.com

e-Procurement Notice - Bid Identification No.: GCE, KIP (KGED-I)-08/2026-27
(Pertaining to Kanpur Canal Division-I, Jhumpura)

S. No.	Name of the Work	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
1.	Total No. of Package	03 (Three Nos. of Work)
2.	Estimated Cost	Rs.191.69 Lakh to 654.23 Lakh
3.	Period of completion	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
4.	Class of Contractor	"B" or "A" or "Special" Class as per Detailed Tender Call Notice
5.	Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	01.09.2026 from 10.00 Hours to 01.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
6.	Last date / Time for receipt of bids in the portal	17.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
7.	Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Technical Bid)	18.09.2026 at 11.00 Hours
8.	Name and address of the Officer Inviting Bid	(Er. Mahendra Kumar Behera) Chief Construction Engineer, Kanpur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Dist.-Keonjhar, Odisha - 758047.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal "https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in" (Er. Mahendra Kumar Behera)
Chief Construction Engineer,
Kanpur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Keonjhar, Odisha
32001775/2627 OIPR-32001/32376/1/26-27/0005

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
AGRICULTURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT
T1/30213/2026 TENDER NOTICE Date: 29.08.2026

For and on behalf of the Governor of Tamil Nadu, e-Tenders are invited from Manufacturers or Authorised Sole Distributor for SI. No. 1 to 3 and Manufacturers or Authorised Sole Distributor or Authorised Dealer for SI. No. 4 to 6 by the Chief Engineer (AE), Agricultural Engineering Department, 487, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai-35 for the following items, as per the terms and conditions and detailed specification listed in the tender document.

SI No	Tender No.	Tender for the supply of	EMD (Rs. in lakh)
1	T1-1/2026-2027	60 Nos. of Tractor 2 Wheel Drive	7.80
2	T1-2/2026-2027	60 Nos. of Rotavator	0.90
3	T1-3/2026-2027	3 Nos. of Truck mounted Electrical Logger	1.65
4	T1-4/2026-2027	5 Nos. of Track Type Paddy Combine Harvester	1.75
5	T1-5/2026-2027	10 Nos. of Wheel Type Paddy Combine Harvester	3.50
6	T1-6/2026-2027	5 Nos. of Tractor PTO Operated Disc Rotavator	0.10

The tender documents with detailed specifications and Bill of Quantity (BoQ) are available in www.tntenders.gov.in as per schedule below. Tender documents and Bill of Quantity (BoQ) can be downloaded, filled and uploaded through Internet Explorer or Microsoft Edge from the site www.tntenders.gov.in at free of cost.

Tender Publishing Date and Time	01.09.2026, 10.00 AM
Tender document download - Start Date and Time	01.09.2026, 10.00 AM
Bid submission - Start Date and Time	01.09.2026, 11.00 AM
Bid submission - Closing Date and Time	01.10.2026, 02.00 PM
Bid opening Date and Time	05.10.2026, 03.00 PM

The e-Tenders will be opened online through www.tntenders.gov.in on the date and time mentioned above at the office of the Chief Engineer (AE), Agricultural Engineering Department, Nandanam, Chennai.

DIPR / 2704 / TENDER / 2026 Chief Engineer (AE)

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Mrs.SUMATHI KUMARAN (76), Mother of Ms. N.M. Meenakshi, Chennai - 600103, expired on 31-08-2026. Eyes donated to Rotary Rajan Eye Bank (Project of Rotary Club of Madras T.Nagar), Chennai-17 (Ph: 28340500).

OBITUARY

Smt.C.R.Nagalakshmi
Born 31/03/1935 Died 30/08/2026
W/o (Late) Sri.C.S.Balaram
Attained the Lotus Feet of the Lord
Mourning by:
Dr.C.B.Sanjeevi (Son),
Mrs.C.B.Shanthi (Daughter)
and all Family Members
Ct: 9840194329

IN LOVING MEMORY OF

U. JAYAKRITHIKA
DOB: 31-03-1984 - DOD: 30-08-2026
May her soul Rest In Peace
Forever in Our Hearts.
Mourning by
Family Members. Ph: 86086 00006

DEATH

16th DAY CEREMONY TODAY

DOB: 20-6-1950 -- DOD: 17-8-2026
Mr. M. CHANDRAN
M.A., B.Ed, First Psychological Analyst & District Rehabilitation Officer (Retd.), Govt.T.N.
Mourning by:
Wife: Mrs. Jayanthi Chandran,
Son: Mr. M.C.Nandhi Ganesh,
Daughter-in-law: Mrs. J.Sonika,
& All Family members.
Ph: 9444461403

DEATH

OBITUARY

Mr. K.S. BALAKRISHNAN
11-12-1928 to 28-08-2026
Wife: Indira Balakrishnan
53/27, Flat No 6, Shree Krishna Apartments
Barnaby Road, Kilpauk, Chennai.
Ct: 98403 98315

Chautha Ceremony
In Loving Memory of

Dr. Minakshi Khattar
W/o. Mr. Vijay Khattar
D.O.D: 29.08.2026
Tuesday, 1st Sept 2026, 5:00 p.m.
Gill Adarsh School Auditorium
No.46, V.M. Street, Balaji Nagar,
Royapettah, Chennai - 600014.
Please join us in prayer as we remember her with love and seek peace for the departed soul.
OM SHANTI
Vijay, Vikas, Pooja, Saumya, Vandana, Vidit, Vedant, Savya, Samarth and other family members.
Contact: 98400 57375

M.DOMINIC RAJ
M.A., M.Phil., Ph.D.
RETIRED PROFESSOR & HEAD OF ENGLISH
VHNSN COLLEGE, VIRUDHUNAGAR
A distinguished scholar, he devoted six years to the first complete English translation of all 3,615 stanzas of Veeramunivara's Thembavani.
6th JANUARY 1942 - 30th AUGUST 2026
FUNERAL MASS
Tuesday, 1st September 2026 at 10:00 A.M., St. Teresa's Church, Nungambakkam
DEEPLY MOURNED BY
WIFE
J. CAROLINE, M.Com., M.Phil., Ph.D.
Retired Head of Commerce
V.V.V. College for Women, Virudhunagar
SONS
D. PIUS RAJ, B.Com., FCA, Grad. CWA
D.CHARLES RAJ, B.Com., FCA
DAUGHTERS-IN-LAW
MARIA FRANCINA & TANUSHA JOAN
GRANDDAUGHTERS
MARILYN PRIYA, MICHELLE REENA & CHRISTINE ROSHNI
RELATIVES & FRIENDS
CONTACT: +91 98412 79389
"Eternal rest grant unto him, O Lord, and let your perpetual light shine upon him"

OBITUARY

Our beloved
Malathi Padmanabhan
(Ammu, Chithi, Akka, Aunt, Malu)
passed away peacefully
on 29th August 2026
leaving behind her
abundant love and affection
to everyone she has met.
We will miss her.
On behalf of
family and friends.

D V SUBRAMANIAN
1929 - 2026
Formerly of India Meteorological Department
Passed away on August 30 2026
He will be dearly missed by
Shobhana & C. R. Rajendran,
Aravindakshan, Nirupama, Vasudha & Sanjay Sondhi, Grandchildren,
sister Rajeshwari Gopal and Family,
Nieces and Nephews,
and a large circle of friends.
Ph: 9840789582

BIRTH CENTENARY

SHRI.N.KRISHNAMURTHY
01.09.1926 - 24.05.1994
FONDLY REMEMBERED BY
JAYASHREE PRITHAM,
PRIYAMVADHA
PRIYADARSHINI, MAYURESH & ArEnKay Foundation

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

First Death Anniversary
Smt G. Jayalakshmi
DOD: 01.09.2025
Your love, blessings, and cherished memories remain with us always. We offer our prayers with gratitude and seek the Almighty's blessings for your eternal peace.
Forever remembered by your loving family

24th DEATH ANNIVERSARY

SMT. M.B. DHANALAKSHMI(A) SARO
(W.o.Late.M.D. Bhasshiyam,
Appellate Asst. Commissioner (Retd.)
18.05.1932 - 01.09.2002
Remembering you with love. We continue to be inspired and guided by your high ideals.
Family Members
Sri Dhanalakshmi Bhasshiyam Trust
Sri & Co

FIRST ANNIVERSARY

W S JAYAPAL
Retd. Officer, SBI, Anna Salai
DOD: 01.09.2025
A year has passed since you went away, but not a single day goes by without your wisdom, guidance, and teachings are not felt. You gave us a lifetime of sacrifice, and your legacy lives on in every life you touched. Remembered for his discipline, courage, honesty, and dedication to the wellbeing of the family

A Noble Visionary

Shri.M.E.DEVARAJAN
Born: 26.01.1939
Died: 01.09.2008
May your noble and dedicated life inspire us all in our pursuit of achieving excellence in all our Endeavors
Family Members & Staff of
M/s.M.A.ETHIRAJULU NAIDU
M/s. ETHIRAJ HOTEL MART
No.18, Evening Bazaar, Park Town, Chennai-600 003.
IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact: 044-28576300 from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
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Step up regulation

Alternative medicine systems should comply with quality control

Non-government institutions accounted for 86% of Ayurveda and 85% of homoeopathy colleges in 2024, according to government data, showing that the private sector is leading the AYUSH medical education infrastructure's rapid expansion. Permitted seats also rose by 43% and total admission capacity by 25% between 2021 and 2024, when the Centre's AYUR-GYAN allocation for AYUSH education, training, research, innovation and capacity-building, increased nearly sixfold. While similar concerns *vis-à-vis* allopathic medical education have been confined to whether institutions adequately prepare students for evidence-based practice, the questions of the AYUSH systems are about the quality of training and what students are being trained to practise. Given the combination, it is notable that quality issues in India's AYUSH system long pre-date the current boom. In a 2005 audit, the Comptroller and Auditor General found insufficient hospital beds, outpatient services, and/or staff widespread among homoeopathy colleges, with bed occupancy from 1% to 71%. A 2020 *Journal of Ayurveda and Integrative Medicine* article similarly reported that many institutions had a shortfall exceeding 50% in the teaching staff required by standards then. The regulator, the National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM), has often withheld or denied permission to institutions after inspections have found gaps in faculty strength and infrastructure.

While this shows a working regulatory system, the expansion led by the private sector is of additional concern as it is accompanied by incentives for these institutions to maximise student intake while maintaining faculty size and laboratory infrastructure. As of August 21, the NCISM had listed 17 Ayurveda colleges – all private – whose permissions it had denied, several for “non-compliance with inspection process”. In *Hillside Ayurveda Medical College* (2023), the Karnataka High Court acknowledged that “often educational institutions are ... guilty of admitting excess students for financial gains”. The National Commission for Homoeopathy has given 41% of all homoeopathy colleges the lowest grade, including nearly half of all private institutions. Effectively, the expansion of AYUSH education is amid persistent quality issues, including inadequate or disputed faculty strengths, failures in inspection requirements and student intake numbers, and even allegations of fictitious faculty. While it would be premature to infer that the rapid expansion evident will have amplified these problems, the persistent regulatory non-compliance warrants tougher quality control and a reexamination of the incentives for private institutions, together with questions about the evidence backing AYUSH medicinal systems.

Deadly span

India's power infrastructure is emerging as a big threat to vultures

Whereas for many decades the chief concern about vulture safety was centered on chemical threats, the threat of electrocution posed by India's expanding power infrastructure may supersede it. In the 1990s, India's vultures suffered one of the world's worst population crashes, nosediving 99.5% by 2007 from a high of around four crore in the 1980s; the white-rumped, Indian, and slender-billed vultures were nearly wiped out. The culprit was diclofenac, a painkiller for cattle that wrecks vulture kidneys. The government banned the use of diclofenac, with additional bans in 2023 to mitigate threats posed by aceclofenac and ketoprofen, among some other NSAIDs. The birds' decline left carcasses exposed for longer, supporting feral dog populations and leading to rabies outbreaks; a 2024 study in *American Economic Review* estimated that human mortality thus rose 4% and the associated damages cost India \$69.4 billion a year. While electrocution has not become as deadly as NSAIDs have been, the fragility of the vulture population and the proliferation of unsafe power infrastructure warrant early action. One official survey reported in 2025 that vultures were nesting at only 50% of their historic nesting sites. It is no trivial detail that the raptors' wide wingspans mean a large individual can contact two conductors at once. They also have a habit of perching on elevated structures, are attracted to open landscapes, and have incentives to congregate where the availability of food is predictable, a risk enhanced by people dumping food waste around electrical installations.

As *The Hindu* reported based on a recent study in the *Journal of Threatened Taxa*, “relocating a livestock carcass dump 2.4 km away from high-tension power infrastructure near Uttarakhand's Dehradun may have saved these large scavengers from ... electrocution”. An assessment prepared for the State Climate Resilient Power System Development Project also noted an Egyptian vulture and some steppe eagles had been electrocuted on medium-voltage, rather than high-voltage, lines. Research has noted that persistent mortality due to electrocution alone could render a local population extinct. Avian electrocution is also likely under-documented in India since dead birds can be removed by humans or scavenged. As the study indicated, one inexpensive solution is to separate vulture feeding sites from power infrastructure. Other measures to protect raptors, and even other birds, especially near settlements, include insulating conductors, increasing the gap between energised and grounded components or otherwise preventing a bird from bridging them – non-trivial considering vulture wingspans – and installing safe perches.

What is common between Elon Musk, M.K. Stalin, a Catholic bishop in Kerala, N. Chandrababu Naidu, C. Joseph Vijay and Mohan Bhagwat? All of them are asking 'their' people to have more children.

The political consequences of changing patterns of birth, death and the movement of people are being felt the world over. The ongoing Census 2027 operations in India have brought a sense of urgency to this question of uneven population trends across regions and communities. The impending question of delimitation of Lok Sabha constituencies, which is to follow the first Census after 2026, adds another layer of urgency.

Natalism, or pronatalism, is a belief system or policy stance that encourages human reproduction and high birth rates, and there are vocal advocates of this these days in communities around the world. Elections and political debates increasingly involve questions of fertility, migration, ageing, identity and belonging. Mr. Musk speaks of falling birth rates as a major threat to civilisation, particularly western. In India, Mr. Naidu, president of the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh, has urged Telugu families to have more children. Mr. Stalin, president of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, invoked the idea of having “16 children”, rhetorically, for Tamils. Mr. Bhagwat, Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief, has explicitly called for Indian, rather Hindu, families to have three children. The Catholic church asks its members to have bigger families. In the most recent development, the Tamil Nadu government, led by Mr. Vijay, Chief Minister and founder and president of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), has extended one-year maternity leave to women government employees having a third child in Tamil Nadu. In 2024, West Bengal and Trinamool Congress (TMC) Minister Firhad Hakim's remark that Muslims could soon become a majority in the State drew criticism, with the TMC distancing itself from the comment and condemning it.

Take the subject seriously

All this makes political demography – the study of how population changes, such as births, deaths, ageing, and migration, affect government policies, political power, and international security – more salient. Sadly, while there is abundant politics around demography, true scholarship is being stifled by conspiracy theorists seeking political capital and by demographic sceptics who view any discussion of the subject as nativism or xenophobia.

While the global population will continue to grow for some time, that growth is uneven across political boundaries and social groups. India itself is moving rapidly through a fertility transition. India's total fertility rate has fallen below replacement level, to 2.0 children per woman



Varghese K. George

according to the National Family Health Survey (NFHS)-5. Fertility has declined across every major religious community; though the pace of decline has been uneven across regions and communities, the gap is narrowing. Pew Research, using NFHS data, found that Muslim fertility declined from 4.4 children per woman in 1992 to 2.4 in 2019-21, fertility declined among every major religious group and fertility gaps between religious communities have narrowed.

Demographic factors will challenge the existing electoral process. The ‘One person, one vote, one value’ principle in India is not applied blindly, but in consonance with group rights of representation. Social federalism and political federalism are both part of India's democratic design. Rich and poor people both move, though for different reasons. In recent years, around two lakh Indians have been giving up their Indian citizenship on average, each year. The poor also move – from places with fewer opportunities to places with greater opportunities. According to the 2011 Census, India had about 45 crore internal migrants. Some regions are ageing, while others will remain younger for longer. Kerala has the highest median age in India, estimated at 37 years in 2026, and this is projected to reach 47 years by 2051. The median age in Uttar Pradesh is approximately 26.9 years, making it one of the youngest States in India. India's projected median age is about 29.2 years in 2026. Even by 2036, the median age of Uttar Pradesh is projected to reach only 31.7 years, according to some estimates.

What is in focus

Natalism is simplistic rhetoric in response to complex realities. No country or society has easily or consistently reversed a sustained decline in fertility. Countries such as Japan, South Korea, China, and Italy have introduced financial incentives, childcare support, parental leave, and other pronatalist measures, but none has succeeded in restoring fertility to the levels seen in earlier decades. South Korea, despite extensive family policies, continues to have extraordinarily low fertility. Italy, too, has continued to experience declining births despite financial incentives and family-support measures. This suggests that fertility is not simply a question of money. It is tied to housing, employment, education, gender relations, the cost of raising children, and people's expectations about the future.

The reason for continued population growth in many societies is increasingly expanding lifespan and population momentum rather than increasing births. The spread of that growth is uneven across political boundaries and social groups. Similarly, wealth creation and distribution remain uneven and will remain so. Fewer people are being born, people are living longer, moving faster and farther; these factors in combination with demands of democracy and federalism raise challenges that require cool thinking and new imaginative capacity.

Politics must move from profiting from demographic change to sensitively managing and navigating its consequences

The Baltic Way — Gandhi's imprint on Baltic freedom

August 23, 2026, marked the 37th anniversary of the Baltic Way, the historic 1989 human chain that became a watershed moment in the Gandhian-inspired Singing Revolution in Lithuania, Latvia, and Estonia, culminating in the restoration of Baltic independence in 1990-91. Conversations across the Baltic states revealed powerful personal reflections on the Baltic Way and Gandhian non-violence: “We studied India's freedom struggle and chose Gandhian non-violent resistance to reclaim our national freedom from Soviet rule.” “We watched the film *Gandhi* on Lithuanian national television, telecast for 24 hours.” “It was thrilling to join a non-violent protest against the Soviet army at Vilnius Cathedral Square; even as a bullet passed near my ear, I stood firm.” “Baltic Way matters a lot for us today.”

A turning point

The Singing Revolution (1986-91), shaped by songs and non-violence during Mikhail Gorbachev's perestroika and glasnost, reached a turning point with the Baltic Way, when two million people formed a 675-kilometre human chain from Tallinn through Riga to Vilnius, demanding freedom from Soviet rule. It remains a powerful symbol of unity, solidarity, and freedom. The Baltic Way was organised on the 50th anniversary of the 1939 Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact to expose its secret protocol, which divided Eastern Europe into German and Soviet spheres of influence, and paved the way for the Soviet annexation of the Baltic states in 1940. Having gained independence in 1918, the Baltics lost it after 22 years. The Baltic Way exposed Soviet-era repression, leading to the Soviet Union's acknowledgement of the secret protocol's existence and the Baltic states' re-independence in 1991. Its global media coverage drew international attention, while its inscription in



K.B. Usha

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The Mahatma's principles of non-violence have forged enduring bonds between the Baltics and India

UNESCO's Memory of the World Register and Guinness World Records recognition reinforced its international legacy.

An enduring influence

Gandhi's ideas travelled globally, inspiring movements from the American civil rights struggle to South Africa and beyond. Today, the Baltic Way reflects the enduring relevance of his principles of non-violence, truth, and human dignity, while echoing the non-cooperation and civil disobedience of his 1930 Dandi March.

Gandhi showed that moral authority could outweigh military power through ahimsa, satyagraha, civil resistance, mass mobilisation, and the principle that a nation's rule depends on people's consent and cooperation. The Baltic Way and the Singing Revolution stand as a testimony to the success of people's power and civilian-based defence drawn from the Gandhi-led Indian freedom movement.

The Singing Revolution's leaders drew on global traditions of non-violent resistance. Latvian scholar Maija Küle noted that, lacking local theorists, they turned to Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr.; Latvia's earlier cultural links with India may also have encouraged this attraction to Gandhian ideas. Lithuania, too, played a key role in developing non-violent civilian-based defence inspired by Gandhi.

In a 2012 conversation with this writer, the late Prof. Gražina Miniotaitė, a leading ideologue of Lithuania's Singing Revolution, recalled that non-violence was widely understood from the outset as essential. The December 1990 “Republic in Danger” declaration urged adherence to “non-violence and non-cooperation with the occupational authorities”.

Unlike other thinkers of non-violence, Miniotaitė regarded Gandhi as the most successful in both theory and practice, demonstrating that non-violent struggle could

Studying the interlinkage between politics and demography is a marginal field within political science and demography, but it should not remain so. In many countries, such as the United States and India, the question of federalism is also in play alongside demography and the economy. A balance will have to be achieved both across social groups nationally and across States in terms of developmental outcomes, growth, opportunities, and political power. India's southern States, for instance, achieved fertility decline earlier and now face the possibility of ageing faster than States with relatively younger populations.

The political question is not simply who has more people, but who has invested in development, who has fewer young people entering the workforce, who needs resources, and how representation should respond to these differences. In a utopian world, if all of humanity were one, no consideration other than individual identity should come into play. But these questions are, for better or worse, framed in terms of group identities. Recognition of group identities is not alien to democratic practice; it can be an integral and essential part of it. The political problem, therefore, is not that groups exist. It is how democratic institutions and development planning can accommodate changing group identities without turning demographic differences into permanent political antagonism.

Impact on planning and politics

The changes in demographic patterns affect both planning and politics. Groups with larger populations will claim greater political power, while groups that are shrinking will feel increasingly insecure. As the number of older and retired people grows relative to the working-age population, their care will require higher commitment of national resources. When these demographic differences vary across regions, they can create friction between States as resources and people move across borders – from regions where there is more to regions where there is less. Regional demographic differences can also cause disputes over taxation, fiscal transfers, development, and political representation.

World over, conversations about demographic shifts have become a source of diatribe. While one group talks about replacement theory and fears that its race is being wiped out, another dismisses such concerns as conspiracy theories. Demographic change is neither a conspiracy to replace any community nor an imagined phenomenon. It is real, natural, and likely to be difficult to reverse. Politics needs to shift from trying to profit from demographic change to sensitively managing and navigating it. The question, then, is whether there can be a more expansive idea of “The People.”

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Turning to science

The tragedy in Nepal is heartbreaking with the loss of many lives and displacement of many. The Himalayas are home to massive glaciers and experts now warn that regions closer to India could face similar avalanches. Instead of waiting for the

next calamity, should not governments invest in research for preventive action? For instance, exploring scientific methods to safely scatter unstable ice masses before they collapse naturally? If science can contemplate diverting asteroids in space, surely we can find a solution for a

threat whose location and magnitude are well known to us. This could be taken up as a global project under the United Nations, with all nations contributing funds and expertise to save humanity from such disasters. **B.C. Ramani**, Hyderabad

Trees felled in one swoop

There is increasing felling of trees in the name of development. Roads, highways, buildings and other construction projects are expanding rapidly, but unfortunately, thousands of trees are being cut down. Development is necessary for progress, but it should

not come at the cost of our environment. Trees provide oxygen, reduce air pollution, regulate temperatures and help maintain ecological balance. Their large-scale removal contributes to rising temperatures, air pollution, soil erosion and the loss of wildlife habitats. Authorities should adopt

development plans that minimise tree loss. Wherever trees must be removed, they should be replaced through proper plantation drives.

Vandit Jain, Chandigarh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The battle within the BJP in Bengal

One hundred days after the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) ended 15 years of Trinamool Congress rule in West Bengal, a consequential battle is unfolding in the State within the BJP itself.

By taking oath as Bengal's first BJP Chief Minister, Suwendu Adhikari inherited a State that had voted for rapture. Voters rejected extortion, strongmen, patronage, unreliable employment, and the migration of young Bengalis. The mandate carried special weight for the BJP, and the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) which had spent decades building an organisation in the State when electoral power seemed distant.

Yet Bengal has changed political colour faster than political culture. Trinamool offices, auto and e-rickshaw stands once controlled by Trinamool workers now carry BJP flags; strongmen who once stood beside Trinamool legislators now appear beside BJP leaders. The contradiction is stark: Mr. Adhikari who promised to dismantle Mamata Banerjee's political system, is consolidating power by absorbing the very same system and networks.

This has created a contest between three forces within the party: the Sangh, seeking ideological continuity; Samik Bhattacharya, the State BJP president, seeking restraint; and Mr. Adhikari, whose instincts were shaped inside the Trinamool.

Three-pronged battle
The RSS's concern is rooted in memory and sacrifice. Its cadres spent decades building the BJP in Bengal, amid violence and isolation. For them, victory was



Sayantan Ghosh
teaches at St. Xavier's College (Autonomous), Kolkata, and is the author of 'Battleground Bengal' and 'The Aam Aadmi Party'

supposed to begin a different political culture.

However, the Chief Minister sees Bengal differently. Power does not reside only in the Assembly or secretariat but in clubs, booths, contractors, transport networks, and strongmen. Bengal has repeatedly shown that while political personnel can change parties, networks survive: Congress moved to the Left, the Left to Trinamool, and now sections of that ecosystem are moving to the BJP. This is where political scientist Dwaipayan Bhattacharya's concept of "party society" becomes crucial – in Bengal, the political party has historically become the principal mediator between citizens, institutions and the State. The CM understands this; his strategy is not to destroy the party society but to inherit it as it consolidates power the fastest.

Mr. Bhattacharya has tried to draw boundaries. He warned cadres against extortion, indiscipline, and misuse of the BJP's name. The party has expelled more than 30 leaders and suspended around 250 over allegations involving corruption, extortion, and anti-party activity. But victory's political energy is fast outrunning organisational restraint.

The contradiction is sharper in the BJP's handling of the Trinamool Congress. While the party says its doors are closed, three former Trinamool Rajya Sabha members have joined the BJP and received nominations immediately. In Parliament, around 20 rebel Trinamool MPs have merged with the Nationalist Citizen Party of India, which in turn, is desperate to merge with the BJP, making claims of

distance difficult to sustain.

Mr. Adhikari's play here is strategic as Ms. Banerjee cannot rebuild her organisation if her leaders are absorbed and networks are transferred. For the RSS, however, the harder question is whether absorbing Trinamool networks also means absorbing their habits. Grassroots workers are unsettled; BJP cadres now see former adversaries accommodated as *Bhalo Trinamool* (good Trinamool). For those who lost homes, livelihoods, and family members during the Trinamool rule, rehabilitation can look like betrayal.

Disrupter or custodian?

A party can absorb individuals without becoming the party they came from. However, inheriting its methods, networks, and political instincts is different.

These 100 days are more than a report card on Mr. Adhikari's government. They mark an argument over what the Bengal BJP will become. For the Sangh, victory vindicated decades of work. For Mr. Bhattacharya, it was supposed to create a disciplined alternative. For the CM, the priority is ensuring that the Trinamool cannot recover. All three can coexist for now. They may not coexist forever.

The danger is that, in seeking permanence rather than merely victory, the BJP may preserve, instead of disrupt, the political system that made the Trinamool powerful. Bengal has changed its government; the harder question is whether the BJP will change the system it inherited or simply become its new custodian.

The need for political unity in Kashmir

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah descended onto New Delhi's streets, in July, with his Cabinet in tow to press for restoration of J&K's federal guarantees – he was denied permission to protest at the emblematic Jantar Mantar. The Peoples Democratic Party chief Mehbooba Mufti, and Srinagar MP Ruhullah Mehdi spearheaded separate programmes in Delhi in the following days. If one had expected this line up of events in the capital to be a surreal moment of reclaiming Kashmir's democratic space for dissent, one was not enthused. What was more prominently illustrated was the deep divisions within the Kashmiri leadership.

After Omar Abdullah came to power in October 2024, he prudently focused on repairing ties with New Delhi. He had hoped that a calibrated navigation would be helpful in negotiating a respectable arrangement for J&K. But in Srinagar, Mr. Abdullah's political opponents described his exploration of areas of agreement with New Delhi and the tailored camaraderie it entailed, as pusillanimous. They iterated that there couldn't be a lesser political goal post in Kashmir than reversing the August 5, 2019 legislations that stripped the Himalayan region of its semi-autonomous status.

While Kashmir's right to dignity and respectable federal arrangement is non-negotiable, the way to realising it cannot be the daily whipping of a rather disempowered local government for not being combative enough. Though this resentment is received



Anando Bhakto
New Delhi-based senior journalist reporting on Kashmir developments

well in the echo canyons of people's online lives, it serves no other purpose except to create a veneer of ideological supremacy for a few. The need of the hour for all of Gupkar's politicians is to contemplate political unity even when grave disagreement simmers beneath the surface. The importance of political unity cannot be overlooked at a time when rest of India's Opposition is palpably wary of involving itself in the Kashmir question.

Nearly two years after the electorate turned out in impressive numbers to elect a local Government and upend the "bureaucratic apparatus" that had settled snugly in its absence, the unelected office of the Lieutenant Governor (LG) continues to wield significant power, heightening confusion. In a region with proximity to violence, it may express itself in a spatter of political dismissiveness: not just of the local government but of participatory democracy itself.

Ensuring Kashmiri participation in elections has always been tricky. It is often the outcome of mainstream leaders' penetrating patronage networks. Rural belts vote more briskly because people have dependence on local politicians, for amenities, and as protective shields against police arbitrariness.

Case studies of several Public Safety Act detainees underscored that local legislators are often the "go to" persons for political and legal support, a favour paid off with the ballot even when one may not be otherwise upbeat about elections. The bureaucratic apparatus created a vacuum which people voted to reverse.

While Kashmir's right to dignity and respectable federal arrangement is non-negotiable, the way to realising it cannot be the daily whipping of a rather disempowered local government for not being combative enough

V-dem's democracy index rates India at its lowest since 1975

The UN CERD's concerns about the exclusion of a large number of voters is in line with the V-Dem Institute's data on India's democratic backslide

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy
Gauri Singavarapu

Last week, the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD), said it was "gravely concerned" about "reports of large-scale violations perpetrated by law enforcement officials" in its first review of India since 2007. The committees' observations included concerns over the exclusion of large number of voters, Muslims in particular, as part of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

UN CERD's criticism seems to be in line with some of the observations in the latest democracy report by the University of Gothenburg-based Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Institute, which uses a multidimensional approach to "conceptualising and measuring democracy." It noted India as one of the countries that is "autocratising" slowly with a systematic dismantling of democratic institutions. This is reflected in the institute's electoral democracy index released in March. While India's performance has gradually declined since 2009, the latest index score is India's lowest since 1975, when the country was under Emergency rule (**Chart 1**). India's scores across parameters such as judicial accountability and corruption, autonomy of the Election Management Body (EMB), and impartial administration by public officials are at their lowest in 50 years. (**Charts 2, 3, 4**).

The decline in autonomy of institutions, as per the report, seems to have accompanied deteriorations in freedom of academic and cultural expression and harassment of journalists (**Chart 5**). Academic freedom measured through indicators such as freedom of academic expression, freedom to research and teach, and institutional autonomy have also declined (**Chart 6**).

New depths

The data for the charts were sourced from the Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Institute, University of Gothenburg, Sweden. Gauri Singavarapu is interning with The Hindu's Data team

CHART 1: V-Dem's democracy index score for India is at its lowest since 1975. It was 0.39 in 1975, slightly higher than the 0.38 recorded in 2025

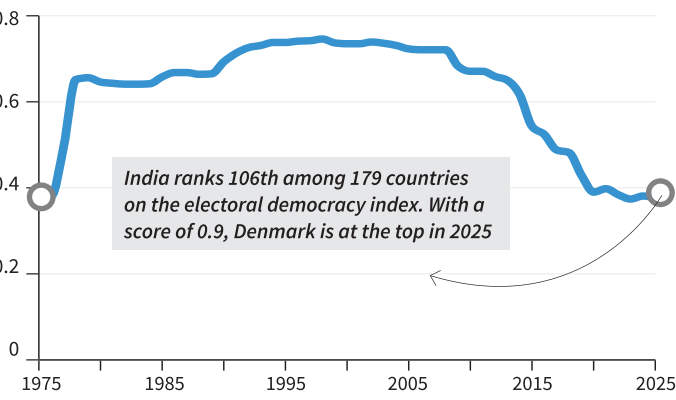


CHART 2: India's scores across election-related indicators involving the functioning of Election Management Body (EMB) and conduct of elections

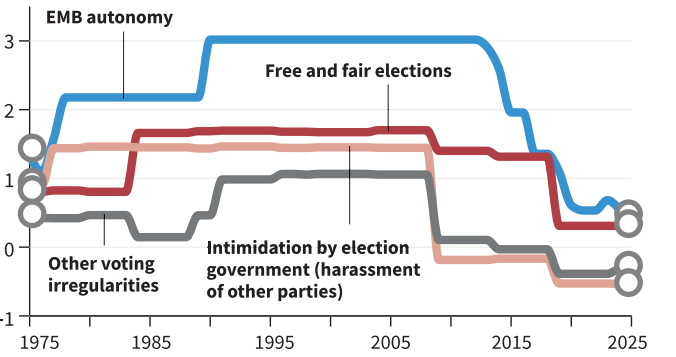


CHART 3: India's scores across indicators on religion, private property, access to justice, and public administration, as per V-Dem Institute's report

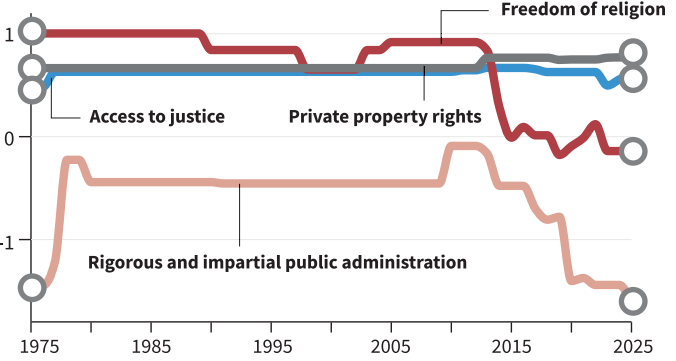


CHART 4:

Select judiciary-related indicators such as compliance with court orders by executives, judicial corruption and accountability

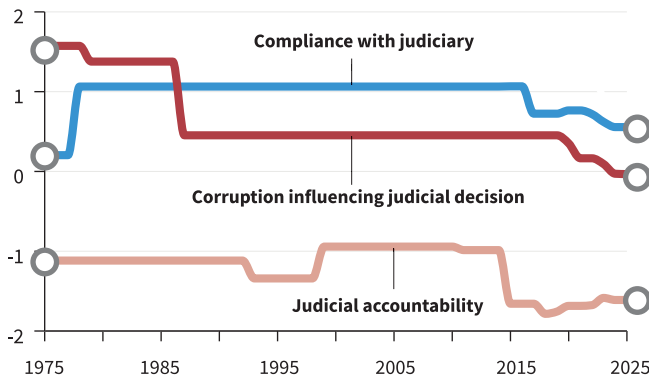


CHART 5:

India's scores across indicators related to media and freedom of expression, as per V-Dem Institute's report

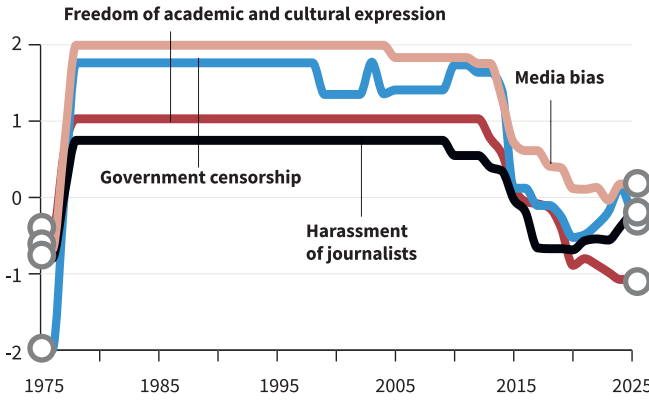
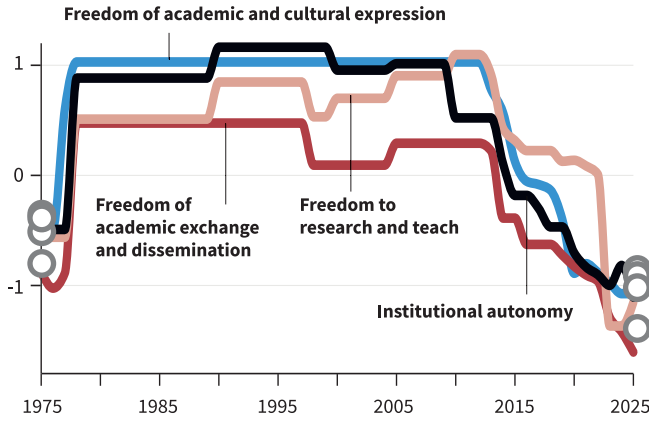


CHART 6:

Select parameters assessing India's academic freedom and institutional autonomy, as per V-Dem Institute's report



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu**.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 1, 1976

Efforts to improve life of Sikkim Lepchas

Gangtok, August 31: The original inhabitants of Sikkim, the Lepchas, who to-day constitute a mere 15 per cent of the State's total population, have a special reason to be happy now. For the first time a detailed land survey has started in their area known as Dzongu in North Sikkim, as a major step towards effective implementation of land reforms in the State.

The backward people of Dzongu do not have any proper records of their rights and lands. For long this place has been considered as the property of the former royal family and the poor Lepchas have been exploited by them for decades. Dzongu being in the extreme north of the State has no easy communication with the outside world and so the people have yet to know the world outside. Very few of them can be seen even in the capital of Gangtok.

Most of the earnings of these families are spent on eating and drinking, of which they are extremely fond. Oldtimers in the capital even to-day recall incidents of these people coming here to sell their produce, mainly cardamom, and being satisfied with the liquor served to them by the business community as consideration for their produce.

At a recently organised meeting at Tingbhum in Dzongu, a group of the community elders, passed a resolution favouring drastic changes in their way of life, especially in regard to expenses on marriage.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 1, 1926

Marconi's new invention

An "Englishman" cable from London, dated August 29 states:-

Signor Marconi has successfully experimented with a special loud speaker giving great amplification with enlarged batteries which magnify sounds without sacrificing quality.

He believes they can be developed until the voice carries twenty miles. He is leaving for Italy in his yacht the "Electra" on September 1 and will carry out a series of experiments to determine the strength of the beams operating between England and Canada and England and South Africa in order to increase the efficiency of long distance transmission and prevent countries for which they are not intended receiving the waves.

From Page One

Ensure peace, freedom of navigation: PM to Iran

President Pezeshkian said his country had a “responsibility” to defend the Iranian people “from danger and insecurity and to create conditions necessary for them to achieve peace, tranquillity and security”. He said Iran was “focused on ensuring peace and security and resolving issues through dialogue and negotiations.”

Mr. Pezeshkian blamed Israel and the U.S. for creating “restrictions and obstacles” before Iran and said that “Despite the pressures and restrictions being imposed in an attempt to obstruct Iran’s relations with other countries, Tehran is ready to expand its cooperation with India.”

He referred to the on ceasefire and said, “The Islamic Republic of Iran has remained committed to the obligations it has undertaken within the framework of the agreements, but unfortunately, the American side has failed to fulfil its commitments.”

Over 6 crore names deleted so far in SIR 3.0

Delhi was closely followed by Dadra and Nagar Haveli, and Daman and Diu for the highest percentage of deletions.

In absolute numbers, Karnataka had the second-most deletions, at 1.07 crore, after Maharashtra. Telangana has the third-highest number of deletions, with 73,39,235 names removed, followed by Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, 44,89,512, and Jharkhand, 43,61,987. In Haryana, 33.83 lakh names were deleted in the draft list, while Punjab saw 20,66,635 deletions and Odisha 20,12,557.

In a letter to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has raised serious concerns over what he called the “massive and unjustified” voter deletions under the SIR process, urging the EC to extend the claims and objections window. Telangana Chief Minister has also done the same.

Minor girl gang-raped on moving bus in Noida

Driver, conductor of sleeper bus offered to drop the girl at Noida’s Sector 63 after she had mistakenly reached Pari Chowk before the crime, say police; Congress, AAP slam Delhi govt.

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

A 17-year-old girl from Uttar Pradesh was allegedly gang-raped by a bus driver and conductor inside a moving sleeper bus after they offered her a lift amid heavy rain in the Delhi-National Capital Region, the police said on Monday.

The alleged sexual assault reportedly took place around 11.30 p.m. on August 4 during a 60-km journey from Pari Chowk in Greater Noida to Sector 63 in Noida and then towards Outer Ring Road, where the girl was abandoned.

The accused, Kuldeep (driver) and Sandeep (conductor), have been arrested while the bus has been seized and sent for forensic examination.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) Niharika Bhatt said the girl, a Class 11 student from Mainpuri district of Uttar Pradesh, had left her home to visit her cousin in Sector 63. Amid heavy rain and darkness, she accidentally reached Pari Chowk in Greater Noida.

The empty sleeper bus



The police have seized the bus for forensic examination; the sleeper bus is seen parked near Timarpur police station. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

passing through the area stopped after she signalled to the driver. The driver and conductor told her they were heading towards Noida Sector 63 and offered to drop her there, the official said.

Assault and threats

Shortly after the bus began moving, the conductor made obscene gestures towards the girl. The two accused then allegedly sexually assaulted her inside the bus and threatened to kill her if she resisted, according to her statement to the police.

The girl told the police that the bus reached Sector 63 but the driver continued towards Delhi, eventually taking her to Ring

vernments in Delhi and Uttar Pradesh over women’s safety. In a post on X, the party said the incident had “shaken the nation”.

The party alleged that there was no adequate patrolling or checking, and said the case exposed what it described as “hollow claims” about women’s safety under the BJP governments.

CM slammed

AAP leader Saurabh Bhadraraj criticised Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta over the government’s handling of cases involving children. In a video message, he described her approach towards cases of child rape as “insensitive” and “disgusting”, and alleged that Delhi was becoming a “capital of child rape”, citing other recent cases.

Following the incident, National Human Rights Commission member Priyank Kanoongo said, “We have taken cognisance of the incident and issued notices to the authorities. We have sought information on the child’s rehabilitation, social investigation and care plan.”

Road near the Kashmere Gate area.

The accused then dropped her near Kashmere Gate and fled. The girl took an autorickshaw to Kashmere Gate police station and reported the incident, the DCP said.

The police immediately formed teams to trace the bus and identified the vehicle. The two accused were subsequently traced to a bus parking lot in Timarpur in north Delhi and arrested. The seized bus has been sent for forensic examination.

The police are now preparing to file a chargesheet in the case.

The case triggered a political row, with the Congress targeting the BJP go-

Centre defers Census exercise in Manipur amid NRC demands

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Union government has deferred Census operations in Manipur, the Chief Minister’s Office said on Monday.

The decision followed a high-level review meeting in New Delhi to assess the current situation in the State. Union Home Minister Amit Shah headed the meeting, which was attended by Manipur Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla, Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, and other senior officials.

The focus of the meeting was on the demand raised by the people of Manipur, specifically Meitei, Pangals (Meitei Muslims), and Nagas, to update the National Register of Citizens (NRC) before conducting the Census. “It was agreed to defer the Census exercise in the State considering the feelings and aspirations of the people,” the Chief Minister said.

The Chief Minister reminded certain groups in Manipur that shutdowns and general strikes would not help in pressing their demands before the government. Instead, he urged the civil society groups to continue dialogue and extend full coop-



Yumnam Khemchand Singh

eration to the administration in addressing the socio-political challenges of the State.

HC order on Census

The High Court of Manipur also ordered that the Census exercise in the State remain deferred until further orders. The exercise was scheduled to begin on September 1. On Monday, a Special Bench comprising Chief Justice M. Sundar and Justice A. Guneswar Sharma heard two separate petitions, one filed by the Kangleipak Students’ Association and the other by Shanta Nahakpam, the convener of 14 civil society groups.

The petitions sought directions to update the NRC using 1951 as the base year and to address concerns over illegal migration from Myanmar before the Census is carried out.

Gunmen kill 3 Kuki villagers in Manipur’s Kangpokpi

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Unidentified gunmen on Monday killed three Kuki villagers, two of them women, and injured four along the same road in Manipur’s Kangpokpi district, where four Liangmai Naga civilians were gunned down on August 27.

According to Kuki-Zo organisations, the incident occurred around 9.30 a.m. They said suspected members of two Naga extremist groups attacked N. Teikhang Kuki village near IT Road and opened fire while torching several houses. N. Teikhang Kuki village is close to Makui Ashang village, near where suspected Kuki extremists allegedly killed the four Nagas in the previous week.

The conflict in Manipur shifted to the hills between the Kuki-Zo and the Nagas in February.

Manipur Deputy CM, 8 MLAs threaten to walk out of govt.

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Manipur Deputy Chief Minister Losii Dikho has urged the Union government to take punitive measures against fellow Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen for “colluding” with a Kuki insurgent group allegedly involved in the killing of Naga civilians.

Mr. Dikho and eight other Naga MLAs also threatened to pull out of the Bharatiya Janata Party-led government in Manipur if no action is taken against Ms. Kipgen and the leaders of Kuki-Zo extremist groups.

Five of these MLAs, including Mr. Dikho, are from the Naga People’s Front (NPF), two are from the BJP, one from the National People’s Party, and one is an Independent.

They listed their demands in a letter to Union Home Minister Amit Shah on August 29. “The letter



Losii Dikho

was hand-delivered today [Monday],” Mr. Dikho said.

In the letter, the MLAs demanded the arrest of Kuki-Zo leaders who publicly claimed responsibility for the killing and dismemberment of six Naga civilians, whose mutilated bodies were recovered on June 10 – almost a month after they were abducted.

Arrest sought

They also demanded the arrest of Thangboi Kipgen, the head of the extremist Kuki National Front (Presi-

dential) faction and Ms. Kipgen’s husband. “Initiate action against Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen as her office is colluding with the Kuki militant group led by her husband...” the letter read.

The Naga MLAs further demanded the immediate abrogation of the Suspension of Operation agreement that the Centre had signed with 25 Kuki-Zo rebel groups in 2008, citing alleged repeated violations and acts of terror against civilians. “When the mutilated bodies of the six Naga men are still unclaimed in protest against the non-arrest of the perpetrators, another four Naga men were mercilessly killed in the IT road ambush on August 27, carried out by the Kuki militants,” the MLAs wrote, citing other incidents of violence.

Manipur had 10 Naga MLAs. One of them, N. Kayisii of the NPP, died in January 2025.

Indian firm signs pact for co-production of U.S. missile

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) and the Javelin Joint Venture (JJV), a partnership between U.S. defence firms Raytheon and Lockheed Martin, have signed a memorandum of understanding to explore the co-production of the Javelin All Up Round missile in India.

The agreement comes days after the Indian Army signed a Letter of Offer and Acceptance with the U.S. for the procurement of the Javelin anti-tank guided missile system.

According to a joint statement, under the industry MoU, TASL and JJV will explore establishing a final assembly and integration facility for the Javelin missile in India, along with capabilities for manufacturing components domestically.

SC Collegium picks new Chief Justice for Rajasthan High Court

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court Collegium on Monday recommended Chhattisgarh High Court judge, Justice Sanjay K. Agrawal, for appointment as the Chief Justice of Rajasthan High Court.

The resolution by the Collegium headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant came a weekend after letters written by serving top court judge, Justice Sandeep Mehta, complaining of the conduct of Rajasthan Acting Chief Justice S.P. Sharma, came to light through reports in the media. Justice Mehta, in a series of three letters in August, had accused Justice Sharma of “favouritism” and misconduct.

Chief Justice Kant, in a press statement, had said the Collegium would consider Justice Mehta’s allegations through an institu-



Supreme Court

tional mechanism. The Collegium has also recommended new Chief Justices to two other High Courts of Madhya Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh. Justices Alpesh Yeshvant Kogge of Gujarat and Dr. Pushpinder Singh Bhati of Rajasthan have been suggested for appointments as Chief Justices to Madhya Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Courts, respectively.

SC raps probe agencies for ‘dragging feet’ in powerful persons’ cases

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday said probe agencies drag their feet when it comes to investigating or interrogating persons in authority, but do not bat an eyelid in cases dealing with ordinary persons.

The observations were made by a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant while hearing a petition filed by Sumit Roy, the personal assistant to Trinamool Congress MP Abhishek Banerjee, in connection with the Salboni land-grabbing case. In the previous hearing, the court stayed the arrest of Mr. Roy.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for Mr. Roy, said his questioning by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) was mostly about his family and the political party’s activities.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the ED, said the ED has confronted Mr. Roy and argued for his custodial interrogation, pointing out that approximately ₹30 crore was transferred to Leaps and Bounds Private Limited, a company linked to Mr. Banerjee.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi said the Calcutta High Court had expressed considerable “despair” at the lack of intensity in the interrogation of persons in the case. “In the ordinary prism of criminal investigation, you do not bat an eyelid to pass appropriate directions to enable the investigating agencies. But an additional layer comes in when agencies investigate authorities in respect of overlapping proceeds of crime investigations. They drag their feet on custodial investigation at certain times, and activate themselves at other times,” Justice Bagchi said.

Congress calls GDP numbers ‘Greatly Distorted Picture’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday questioned the 7.8% GDP growth recorded in the April-June quarter, with the party’s communication chief Jairam Ramesh describing the figures as a “GDP – Greatly Distorted Picture” of the state of the economy.

In a post on X, Mr. Ramesh said the quarterly numbers failed to reflect the “decidedly depressed” private investment sentiment among both domestic and foreign investors. He said consumer confidence had fallen to its lowest level since the COVID-19 pandemic, while

Ramesh says consumer confidence had fallen to its lowest level since the COVID-19 pandemic

prices of household essentials were rising.

Mr. Ramesh also flagged the trade deficit with China, falling household savings and record levels of household debt. He alleged that the concentration of key sectors in the hands of a few large conglomerates had aggravated inequality, claiming that the wealth of India’s five richest families had risen sharply even as real wages had declined.

Family of U.S. citizen held on terror charges seeks diplomatic help over his ‘poor health’

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The family of a U.S. citizen, who was arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) along with six Ukrainians on charges of illegally crossing into Myanmar from Mizoram to train armed ethnic groups in weapons handling and drone warfare, has said that U.S. Ambassador to India Sergio Gorr has raised the issue with Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri and U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio, when the latter was on a visit to Delhi in May.

The family of Matthew Van Dyke, who was detained at the Kolkata airport on March 11 and later



Dyke’s advocate says he is in a high-security ward in Tihar and his judicial custody has been extended till September 8.

arrested by the NIA, has renewed calls for urgent diplomatic intervention amid concerns over his health and prison conditions.

The External Affairs Ministry is yet to respond to the issue.

Sons of Liberty International, the NGO founded by Mr. Van Dyke, said that the accused reportedly began a liquids-only hunger strike on May 6, which he attempted to end on June 18.

“A humanitarian food application was approved July 21. Matthew Van Dyke has yet to receive approved mosquito nets, and kettle. Matthew is reportedly eating only oatmeal as other purchased foods are not provided to him,” it added.

The family said Mr. Van Dyke was transferred from the NIA headquarters to Tihar Jail in Delhi on April 6 “despite suffering from an

injured leg, declining eyesight, and without access to his prescribed medication.”

It said that his mother, Sharon Van Dyke, who is over 80, was only allowed a five-minute emergency call with him months ago.

Advocates Rohit Dandriyal and Rohit Gour applied to the Delhi Court for Mr. Van Dyke’s medical treatment at a private hospital and establishment of proper communication with his family in the U.S.

“However, the Delhi Court denied both application requests on June 1 alleging foreign government communications,” the statement added.

Mr. Gour said that Mr. Van Dyke is lodged in a

high-security ward in Tihar and his judicial custody has been extended till September 8. “The NIA is yet to file a chargesheet and the specific allegations against Van Dyke are not clear,” he said.

Mr. Van Dyke, along with six Ukrainians, has been charged under Section 18 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). Earlier, the NIA had told the court that they had entered India on tourist visas and later travelled to Mizoram allegedly without obtaining the required Protected Area Permit, crossed the border to Myanmar, and were allegedly planning to train anti-India ethnic armed groups there.

‘Hydrocarbon exploration scheme to benefit Adani’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Alleging that the Centre’s ₹84,084-crore Samudra Manthan scheme for off-shore hydrocarbon exploration was designed to benefit the Adani Group, the Congress on Monday demanded that it either be scrapped or that its entire outlay be diverted to the public sector Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC).

Addressing a press conference here, Congress spokesperson Shaktisinh Gohil said the Union Cabinet approved the scheme last month for its first phase, and claimed that it had created a framework under which companies undertaking offshore exploration, including Adani-owned Well Spun Exploration Ltd. (AWEL), would receive substantial financial support from the government.

Mr. Gohil asked why ONGC, which had decades of experience in hydrocarbon exploration, was not being given the primary role in the national mission.

There was no response from the government or the Adani Group to the Congress’s allegations.

PM calls for ‘end of war’ at meeting with Putin

The two leaders discuss conflicts in West Asia and Black Sea region, impact on maritime trade and safety of Indian seafarers; Putin highlights positive trends in Moscow-New Delhi economic ties

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday met Russian President Vladimir Putin on the sidelines of the SCO summit in Bishkek and said the world “must move from endless war to end of war for the benefit of humanity”.

The External Affairs Ministry said the two leaders discussed conflicts in West Asia and in the Black Sea region, where, in recent months, Indian seafarers have been attacked by both Russian and Ukrainian forces.

“Had extensive discussions with President Putin. Discussed the full range of the India-Russia Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership. It is gladdening to see significant progress across various sectors in recent years. Focus areas for India-Russia friendship remain energy, innovation, space, fertilizers, and people-to-people linkages,” said Prime Minister Modi.

In a statement, the External Affairs Ministry said,



Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin during a meeting in Bishkek on Monday. ANI

Number of Indian students in Russia increased almost seven-fold in a decade, says Putin

“They also shared perspectives on key regional and global issues of mutual interest, including the conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea region which have impacted maritime trade and the safety and security of Indian seafarers. Prime Minister reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy was the way forward in

resolving conflicts.” The upcoming BRICS summit featured prominently in the discussion, and Mr. Modi said he “looks forward to welcoming President Putin in India for the 18th BRICS summit on 12-13 September”.

80th anniversary of ties

The Bishkek meeting between Mr. Modi and Mr. Putin featured in talks during External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar’s visit to the Kremlin on August 24, when Mr. Putin had indicated that he would meet Prime Minister Modi in

Kyrgyzstan and also at the BRICS summit in Delhi.

“This time, our meeting is taking place on the eve of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Summit - an organisation that works to deepen contacts among the countries of the Global South and East, promotes the region’s socioeconomic and cultural development, and contributes to building a just multipolar world,” said President Putin in his remarks, reminding that next year will mark the 80th anniversary of establishment of diplomatic relations between New Delhi and Moscow.

Mr. Putin noted that the number of Indian students in Russia has increased almost seven-fold in a decade, and currently 40,000 Indians are studying in Russia.

President Putin said trade and economic cooperation between Russia and India is showing positive trends, with trade turnover increasing by more than 2%. He noted the growth in tourist exchanges between the two countries, with a 16% increase in 2025.

India rejects Hague court’s Indus Waters Treaty ruling, says it has no jurisdiction

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Hours after the Permanent Court of Arbitration at The Hague said the Indus Waters Treaty remains “fully in force” and called on India to “observe its obligations”, the External Affairs Ministry rejected this, saying that the “very establishment of this alleged arbitral body” was a “grave violation” of the treaty.

“This so-called Court was constituted by the World Bank in patent breach of the terms of the Treaty, and India categorically rejects its so-called award,” the Ministry said on Monday.

It went on to say that India had “never recognised the existence in law of this illegally-constituted and so-called Court of Arbitration, and has consistently maintained that the very establishment of this alleged arbitral body constitutes a grave violation of the Indus Waters Treaty”.

“Accordingly, India has never appeared before this body and has refused to take any cognisance of its earlier pronouncements,” the Ministry said.

India had placed the In-



India had placed the treaty in abeyance following the Pahalgam terror attack.

dus Waters Treaty “in abeyance” following the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22, 2025, and the Ministry, in its response on Monday, reiterated its position. “India’s decision to hold the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance remains in force,” it said.

The Ministry also said that “this so-called Court of Arbitration has no jurisdiction whatsoever to pronounce on India’s sovereign decisions”.

It added that the court’s pronouncements, “now or in the future, will have no effect on India’s actions in connection with the projects being undertaken by India”.

Earlier, the arbitration body, considering Pakis-

tan’s plea, examined the reasons under which India placed the treaty “in abeyance” and said that “none of these grounds could justify suspension or termination of the Treaty”.

Issuing an “award” on the ‘Status of the Indus Waters Treaty and Order on Interim Measures concerning the Ratle Hydro-Electric Plant (RHEP)’, the Permanent Court of Arbitration said, “Accordingly, the Indus Waters Treaty remains fully in force, and India must observe its obligations under the Treaty, including those relating to the design and operation of its hydro-electric projects on the Western Rivers.”

It had also considered Pakistan’s plea on imposing measures on India regarding the RHEP, saying, “In a unanimous decision, the Court decided to impose measures prohibiting India from concreting the RHEP dam wall and power intake structure above certain levels until 90 days after the Neutral Expert’s final decision, which is expected in July 2027.”

The Court of Arbitration is chaired by Prof. Sean D. Murphy of the U.S.

FIR against Rahul exposes BJP’s casteist mindset: Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

After the Uttarakhand Police registered a case against Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over his remarks on the “purification” ceremony which “insulted” Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, the party on Sunday said it “exposed BJP’s casteist mindset”.

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal announced that party workers across the country would take to the streets on Monday evening to demand “prosecution of the BJP leaders who insulted Khargeji and to defend our Constitution against

the BJP’s assault on its values of social justice”.

The party described the first information report (FIR) against Mr. Gandhi as an attempt to divert attention from the allegations of caste discrimination and suppress the voices demanding action against those involved in the purported “*shuddhikaran*” (purification) ceremony at the venue of Mr. Kharge’s public meeting in Haldwani in Uttarakhand.

“What is worse is that the BJP jumped in to defend this abhorrently casteist behaviour, showing to the entire world that they are the biggest perpetrators of social injustice today,” Mr. Venugopal said.

He alleged that the BJP



K.C. Venugopal

was willing to deploy the “entire might of the State” against those who spoke out against atrocities committed against Dalits.

“What the BJP has done is to attack the values of social justice enshrined in the Constitution, and the Congress will fight against this attack tooth and nail,” he said. “We will not rest

until the true culprits of the insult to Khargeji are punished, and this frivolous FIR against Rahulji is thrown in the dustbin.”

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said Mr. Gandhi had raised the issues of injustice, humiliation and discrimination faced by Dalits, and alleged that the BJP-RSS had “proved him right” within 24 hours.

‘Bid to divert attention’

“This is the very mindset against which Babasaheb’s Constitution stands as the greatest wall,” Mr. Ramesh said, alleging that the BJP was seeking to divert attention and suppress dissent.

Congress general secretary in charge of Uttarak-

hand Kumari Selja questioned why no FIR had been registered against those who allegedly conducted the ritual.

“No action against those who conducted the ‘purification’ ritual after Congress President Shri Mallikarjun Khargeji’s public meeting, but an FIR against Leader of Opposition Shri Rahul Gandhiji for raising his voice against that casteist act. Is this the justice of the BJP government?” she asked.

The Congress’s Scheduled Castes department chairman Rajendra Pal Gautam alleged that the incident amounted to a violation of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of

Atrocities) Act and questioned the police’s failure to act against those allegedly responsible.

On the issue of FIR, BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said at a press conference: “There has never been, nor will there ever be, a leader in India more irresponsible and more anti-Dalit... than Rahul Gandhi. He should introspect.”

The BJP leader said that after Mr. Kharge alleged that he had been insulted, Mr. Gandhi did not take notice of it for three weeks.

“Rahul Gandhi has time to travel around the world. However, when someone from the Dalit or backward community makes an allegation, he himself does not take it seriously,” he said.

SC rejects petition for mandatory ethanol disclosure at pumps

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday refused to entertain a petition alleging an element of “silent compulsion” in the rollout of E20 petrol and seeking mandatory disclosure of the ethanol content in petrol sold at fuel stations across the country.

A Bench of Justices M.M. Sundresh and Prasanna B. Varale was hearing a petition by advocate and petitioner-in-person Narendra Kumar Goswami, contending that consumers were

entitled to know the composition, quality, standards and compatibility implications of the fuel they purchase. Such disclosure, the plea said, was not a “decorative consumer slogan but a constitutional requirement when the State itself creates a nationwide compulsory market”.

The Bench declined to entertain the plea, observing that the petitioner could approach the competent authority with his grievance instead of directly moving the Supreme Court.

After SC refusal to halt CJP march, police seek quashing of FIRs against protesters

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Within hours of the Supreme Court refusing on Monday to halt a protest march announced by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in central Delhi ahead of the BRICS Summit, the Delhi Police moved an urgent plea to quash first information reports (FIRs) registered against students and youth who participated in the NEET-UG paper leak protests.

Days before the BRICS Summit on September 12-13, the CJP decided to hit the streets again on September 5, citing the Centre’s failure to live up to its assurances, including the immediate withdrawal of FIRs against student protesters.

Earlier in the day, a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant found no “compelling circumstance” to interfere with CJP’s plans for a protest march.

In the afternoon, as the Bench was preparing to rise for the day, Solicitor-



The Delhi Police said it did not wish to pursue FIRs registered after the crackdown on July 20.

General Tushar Mehta orally mentioned an application filed by the Delhi Police urging the apex court to invoke Article 142 of the Constitution to quash the FIRs. Mr. Mehta pushed for a hearing on September 1 itself.

The Delhi Police said it “no longer wished” to pursue the FIRs registered across various police stations in central Delhi against students and protesters following the crackdown on July 20. These FIRs had arraigned charges of rioting, attempt to murder, and damage to public property against protesters.

The police expressed willingness to close any other FIRs which were not mentioned in the application. They sought the court’s permission to file “fresh, specific” FIRs only against 2,873 individuals with criminal antecedents, who were reported to be present at the NEET-UG protest site.

Chief Justice Kant agreed to list the application on September 1, remarking, “If parties are reconciling, we have no difficulties.”

The CJI Bench’s refusal earlier in the day to intervene came in separate pleas filed by a retired Delhi Police officer, Rajender Singh, and another, who had objected to the announcement of the September 5 protest march.

Appearing for the petitioners, advocate Syed Rizwan Ahmed said that, to the best of his knowledge, the CJP had not sought permission from either the police or the courts; the decision to march had been announced on social media.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI TENDER NOTICE / REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

RFP/Tender Notice No.: Roc.No.02/DEO/TTD/Tpt/2026-27, Date: 27.08.2026.

TTD invites offline sealed Technical and Financial Proposals under Two- Bid System from eligible and reputed academic institutions/organizations for Selection of an Academic Partner for Providing Integrated Offline Classroom Coaching for Medical, Engineering and Allied Professional Entrance Examinations to Intermediate Students of TTD Junior Colleges for the years 2026-28 (2 years). Bid document available in TTD website www.tirumala.org, from 01.09.2026. Last Date & Time for Submission: 25.09.2026 @ 3.00 PM.

For Details: Phone: 0877-2264062, E-mail: deottd@gmail.com, Website: www.tirumala.org.

TTD-4002131/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.167) Date:31-08-2026

EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Office of the Director, Department of Animal Husbandry, Uttarakhand, Dehradun

E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE

No: 2860-61 /Purchase Cell/ 2026-27/ Dated 31-08-2026

The Chairman, State Purchase Committee, Department of Animal Husbandry, Uttarakhand, on behalf of the Government of Uttarakhand, invites separate e-tenders for Rate Contract for the supply of Veterinary Allopathic Medicines and Veterinary vaccines for Veterinary Hospitals/ Identifying Officers of Uttarakhand. Tender documents shall be available for download on uktenders.gov.in from September 01, 2026, at 10:00 AM. Online bid submission shall close on September 14, 2026, at 5:00 PM.

Director/Chairman State Purchase Committee
Department of Animal Husbandry,
Uttarakhand, Dehradun.

TRAVANCORE DEVASWOM BOARD

Devaswom Commissioner Office
Nanthancode, Thiruvananthapuram - 695 003
E-mail: dcotdb@gmail.com Ph: 9188911421

ROC NO: 26/2026/SAB 31-08-2026

Re E-Tender Notice for Sabarimala

Competitive Re e-tenders are invited from experienced manufacturers, distributors, and contractors through <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> for the supply of required materials for the preparation and distribution of offering Prasadam (Vazhipadu Prasadam) in connection with Mandala-Makaravilakku, Meda Vishu, Monthly Poojas, and other requirements for the year 1202 ME (2026-2027) at Sabarimala, Pamba and Nilakkal Devaswoms under the Travancore Devaswom Board.

Sl.No	Item Required	Quantity	EMD
1.	Powdered Jaggery	5,000 MT	10,00,000/-

Submission closing date : 01-09-2026, 10.00 AM
Re E-Tender starting date : 13-09-2026, 10.00 AM
Re E-Tender opening date : 14-09-2026, 10.00 AM

• More details and conditions are available at our website www.travancoredevaswomboard.org
• All tender processing - related queries will be entertained only online.
Sd/-, Devaswom Commissioner

WATCO

OFFICE OF THE MANAGING DIRECTOR, WATCO

Ground Floor, Unnati Bhawan,
H.B.Colony, Satyanagar, Bhubaneswar-751007, Odisha, India
Telefax: - +91-674-2571444; E-mail - mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com .

INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) - Bid Identification No. WATCO(W)-14/2026-27, Dtd.25.08.2026

WATCO No. 9912 / Date: 25.08.2026

- Name of the work :- 1. Annual Maintenance of Facultative Pond, Wet Well and Pumping Station at Meherpalli.
- Annual Operation and Maintenance of STP, P7 and Septage Treatment Plant and all SPS.
- Estimated Cost : Rs.63.18 Lakh to Rs.257.62 Lakh
- Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Months
- Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal : From 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.09.2026 to 5.00 PM of Dt. 22.09.2026
- Last date / time of receipt of bids : 5.00 PM of Dt. 22.09.2026 in the portal
- Date & Time of opening of technical bids : 12.30 PM of Dt. 24.09.2026
- Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid : MD, WATCO, Telefax:- 0674-2571444. E-Mail : mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com
- The bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only.

Further details can be seen from the web site www.tendersodisha.gov.in .

(Managing Director), WATCO
13001/1704/2627
OIPR-13001/13263/1/26-27/0014

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT

Lokaseva Bhavan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Phone: 0674-2954600/ 7894709964 | Website: <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in> | Mail : rusa.odisha@gmail.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Higher Education Department invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work: The complete set of bidding documents and other details are available at <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in>

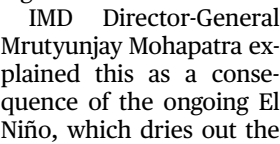
Sl. No.	Name of the Work	Tender No.	Availability of RFP Document	Last date for submission of bids	Opening of technical bids	Tender Fee	EMD
1	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for Ravenshaw University, Kataka (RDE, Bhubaneswar) under of PM-USHA	PM-USHA- 03/2026	31/08/2026 to 22/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	22/09/2026 (till 4:00 PM)	24/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST	₹ 5,00,000/-
2	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for Maharaja Sriram Chandra Bhanja Deo University, Mayurbhanj (RDE, Baleswar) under of PM-USHA	PM-USHA- 04/2026	05/09/2026 to 28/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	28/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	30/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST	₹ 5,00,000/-

Bids for separate works must be sent separately by Speed Post/Registered Post only in the following address:
Joint Secretary to Govt. cum SPD (RUSA/ PM-USHA), Higher Education Dept., Lokaseva Bhavan, Bhubaneswar-751001.
Sd/-
Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)
11001/287/2627
OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0043

A computer-based examination centre in Jaipur's Sitapura area came under scrutiny on Monday after technical problems disrupted an All India Institute of Medical Sciences recruitment exam, a day after an internal power failure at the same facility forced the cancellation of the NEET-PG 2026 exam for 2,445 candidates. The same ION Digital Zone facility was being used for the AIIMS Common Recruitment Examination-5. The institute cancelled the CRE-5 at two exam centres in Jaipur following a disruption caused by internal power supply issues, a source said. The AIIMS has also directed TCS, which operates the exam centres, to submit a detailed report.

He added that this marked the fourth water agreement between States this year, which would enhance water availability for irrigation, rural development and drinking purposes.

September brings in about a fifth of the June-September monsoon rain, less than July's 32% and August's 29%. In recent years, September rainfall has seen a relative uptick. As of August 31, India's cumulative monsoon rainfall was about 14% below normal, with central India in surplus but the northwest, east and northeast, and south peninsula all recording deficits. The shortfall was particularly pro-



Four low-pressure systems, precursors to cyclonic storms, and mostly originating in the Bay of Bengal,

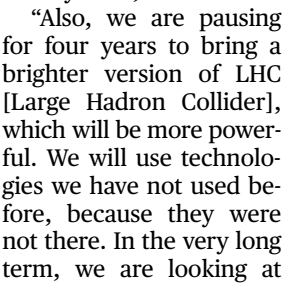
The IMD's models indicate that El Niño conditions are likely to intensify during the remainder of the 2026 southwest monsoon season. The IMD's July 31 outlook for August had indicated "below-normal" rainfall over much of the country, and said this "matched" observations over many regions.

Earlier, the matter had been referred to the third member, as the two-member Division Bench of Ashok Kumar Bhardwaj (Member Judicial), and Reena Sinha Puri (Member Technical), gave a split verdict on the repayment plan.

“Information was received about an explosion at a firecracker factory near Manori power house in the Pipri police station area. Police and fire brigade teams immediately

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath expressed grief over the incident.

While answering questions on the future projects of the CERN, Mr. Thomsson said the Future Circular Collider would push the boundaries of innovation, technology, and imagination. The Future Circular Collider would be a new 91-km ring, which is expected to be operational by 2045.



The High-Luminosity LHC will have 10 times

On the CERN's interest in India, Mr. Thomson said the country had great technological strength. "India has excellent technologies, is well-organised and has brilliant people. We are looking at CERN's future and how India can be a part of that," he said in conversation with *The Hindu* after the programme.

FAITH

Tirukkural and the Gita

Tirukkural, written by Tiruvalluvar, is one of the Tamil literature's greatest ethical works and is honoured as the “*Ulagā Podhu Marai*” (universal scripture). In concise couplets, it teaches the essential principles of human life – *aram* (virtue), *porul* (wealth and social responsibility), *inbam* (love), and the higher goal of *veedu* (liberation or moksha). Its teachings transcend language, religion, race, and nationality, making it relevant to all humanity. It guides individuals in righteousness, truth, compassion, generosity, patience, gratitude, justice, good governance, and social responsibility, said Thaneerpalli Krishnan Swamy in a discourse. Tiruvalluvar emphasises that knowledge alone does not make a person great; love, compassion, good character, and the ability to understand others' suffering are equally important.

There are significant similarities between Tirukkural and the Bhagavad Gita. Both emphasise dharma, righteous action, karma, spiritual wisdom, human effort and liberation. Hindu dharma teaches that the *atma* is spiritual in nature and that the wise recognise the same spiritual reality in different beings. Similarly, Tirukkural emphasises moral equality and compassion towards living beings.

Most importantly, both works direct human beings towards spiritual liberation. Krishna teaches surrender to God as the means to transcend karma, maya, and samsara. Similarly, Tiruvalluvar speaks of crossing the “great ocean of birth” by reaching God's feet. Thus, the Bhagavad Gita and Tirukkural both guide humanity towards dharma, right action, devotion, self-discipline, compassion, and ultimately liberation from the cycle of birth.

THE START OF IT ALL

From a Barcelona product to a champion with Argentina



GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Messi joined Barcelona as a 13-year-old in 2000 and shone in the youth ranks before making his senior debut at 16 in a friendly against Porto in 2003. He made his LaLiga debut in October 2004 and scored his first league goal the following May in a match against Albacete. What he achieved with Argentina is history.

MR. CONSISTENT

Prolific Messi bows out with the second-most international goals



REUTERS

Lionel Messi has the second-most goals in all internationals (125), behind his contemporary, Portugal's Cristiano Ronaldo (146). The Argentine legend is also the second-highest goalscorer in FIFA World Cup history with 21 in 34 matches, behind France forward Kylian Mbappe (22).

GLITTERING

Be it Brazil or Qatar, Messi wowed fans with Golden Ball at his feet



GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Messi is the only player to win the World Cup Golden Ball twice, earning the prize in the 2014 and 2022 editions. While Messi provided four goals and one assist in Brazil, he delivered seven goals and three assists in Argentina's title-winning campaign in Qatar. In the most recent WC, he secured the Silver Ball.

THE LIONEL THAT HELPED

Messi, Scaloni and their successful partnership for La Albiceleste



GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Scaloni's appointment as coach in 2018 proved a game-changer for Lionel Messi and Argentina. In 2021, in the middle of the Covid pandemic, Argentina defeated Brazil 1-0 in the final to win the Copa America, its first major title in 28 years. The crowning glory came in Qatar in 2022 when Messi's side lifted the World Cup.

Messi bids goodbye after 21 magical years

The show-stopper leaves the international arena with an Argentine record 125 goals in 207 matches; despite being hurt, he says the time had arrived to bring down the curtains on a storied career

FOOTBALL

Agencies
BUENOS AIRES

Lionel Messi has ended his decorated career as a player for Argentina at 39, after nearly two decades representing the National team.

The eight-time Ballon d'Or winner is his country's record appearance-maker and scorer with 125 goals in 207 games, having transformed a complicated relationship with the senior side into a story of redemption and triumph.

Messi, who played in six World Cups, won the tournament in Qatar in 2022 and led Argentina to the final again, before losing to Spain in the USA earlier this year.

"It was a decision that hurt – and still hurts deeply – but I understand that the time has come," Messi wrote on social media.

"I swear to you that I always gave it my all – not just in these last few years when we won everything but before that too. I always fought and left everything on the field for this jersey, to bring you joy and make you feel proud to be Argentine through football," added the veteran.

Messi revealed that he wrote his retirement letter on July 21 – two days after losing the World Cup final – but waited to publish it because his father was facing health issues that eventually claimed his life. Jorge Messi passed away in his native Rosario on August 8.

Messi had made his debut for the National team in 2005, but his journey was fraught with frustration until he finally lifted the World Cup in 2022.

"Thank you for all the love these past 20 years. I'm going to miss hearing you all from the inside. Now I'm going to be one of you, cheering and supporting you from the outside [through thick and thin, even more so]," said Messi.

Change of mind

He had briefly retired in 2016 – after defeats in the 2014 World Cup final and back-to-back Copa America title deciders – but later reversed his decision.

He went on to bag Copa titles in 2021 and 2024.

In the letter, the Inter Miami captain, however, did not mention how long he intends to continue playing professional football.

"I leave with the peace of mind and pride of having given you – along with my teammates – moments we once only dreamed of. Experiencing this with you was incredible. I love you all," he added.

Messi played for Inter Miami over the weekend, scoring four in a 7-1 win over CF Montreal in Major League Soccer.



The art and the artist: Messi's wizardry often left defenders chasing shadows. During two decades of dominance, he was head and shoulders above the rest. GETTY IMAGES, REUTERS & AFP

Leo's glorious position in football is set in stone

K.C. Vijaya Kumar

In football's hallowed legacy of individual brilliance shaping collective achievement, the pantheon was always vested with a duopoly: Brazil's Pele and Argentina's Diego Maradona.

Carving his own niche

However, just like the suave manner in which he befuddled defenders, Lionel Messi also carved his own niche with these giants.

Greatness in the beautiful game can never be discussed without mentioning the magician that Messi has always been.

As he announced his international retirement, Messi leaves a global terrain that he adorned with such aura. He was driven by the philosophy that if there was a goal to be scored, he would be the man to do it or at least grant the final assist.

However, Pele and Maradona did not face the extreme scrutiny that shadowed Messi in an age of intrusive social media. For years, the 'club over country' debate was often used to denigrate Messi.

His exemplary stint with FC Barcelona was used as a crutch to run him down while using his tenure with Argentina as a contrast. Messi had to find his light while dealing with Maradona's massive shadow.

Sporting greats thrive on prodigious talent, self-belief, adrenaline and most importantly the applause from the fans. Messi often searched for that last bit. It did not matter if he was the most-feted footballer ever in the history of the sport, he had to win the World Cup.

Ultimate prize

He precisely did that at Doha in 2022, marshalling his unit to the ultimate glory, one that Maradona last secured in 1986. While the rest of the world loved him, to gain that emotion from his followers back home was special for Messi. Finally, Maradona's shadow was cast aside as Messi glowed in his own luminescence.

He wanted an encore this year but Spain had the last word in the World Cup final. The Maradona replication was again at play as Argentina was runner-up in 1990.

To see Messi on the turf is to be aware of magic-realism, the kind that writers like Gabriel Garcia Marquez dished out in their epics. Messi offered hope, hoodwinked rivals with speed and pauses, and sold a dummy with his

Messi's international journey

Breaking down the genius' strikes

Year	Goals
2005	0
2006	2
2007	6
2008	2
2009	3
2010	2
2011	4
2012	12
2013	6
2014	8
2015	4
2016	8
2017	4
2018	4
2019	5
2020	1
2021	9
2022	18
2023	8
2024	6
2025	3
2026	10
Total	125

BY OPPONENT

(top-10)	
Bolivia	11
Ecuador	7
Venezuela	7
Uruguay	6
Algeria	5
Brazil	5
Chile	5
Estonia	5
Guatemala	5
Paraguay	5

Appearances	Goals	Competition
61	54	Friendlies
72	36	World Cup qualification
34	21	FIFA World Cup
39	14	Copa America
1	0	Finalissima



LA ALBICELESTE CAREER

125 goals

and 68 assists in 207 appearances across 21 years. Holds the country's all-time record for both appearances and goals

TITLES WON

- Under-20 World Cup (2005)
- Olympic Games gold (2008)
- FIFA World Cup (2022)
- Copa America (2021 and 2024)

INDIVIDUAL HONOURS

- FIFA World Cup - Golden Ball (2014 and 2022)
- FIFA World Cup - Silver Ball (2026)
- Copa America - Golden Ball (2015 and 2021)
- Copa America - Golden Boot (2021)

1

The only player to score a World Cup goal in his teens, 20s and 30s

1

The first to score in the group stage, round of 16, quarterfinal, semifinal and final of a single World Cup

1

Has the most World Cup goal involvements (33: 21 goals, 12 assists), most World Cup assists (12) and most World Cup appearances (34)

3

The first player to captain his country in three World Cup finals

2014 2022 2026

47

Messi made his La Albiceleste debut on August 17, 2005, coming on as a substitute in the 63rd minute. He, however, received a red card just 47 seconds later for a controversial challenge

28

Messi ended Argentina's 28-year trophy drought in 2021 when it defeated Brazil at the Maracana to lift the Copa America

2016

Retired from international football on June 26, in the aftermath of the defeat to Chile in the Copa America final, before reversing his decision on August 12 later that year

To see him at his best, was to be aware of an incandescent legend. Messi's glorious position in football is set in stone. He will be sorely missed.

Statistics would reveal 125 goals from 207 appearances for Argentina, but he was more than just numbers.

Compiled by Anirudh Velamuri



Nobody can take away the piece of history I achieved

Enekwechi stresses he wants to stay consistent at the top level before his decline; says Nigerian throwers are grappling with infrastructure and funding issues

BISWARANJAN ROUT

INTERVIEW

Chukwuebuka Enekwechi

Y.B. Sarangi

Chukwuebuka Enekwechi presents a fine example of how perseverance can reward an athlete. Despite funding issues, the Nigerian lived in the USA for years to pursue his studies and shot put career before ultimately writing a bit of sporting history. He became the first shot putter from his country to win gold at the Commonwealth Games, achieving the feat in Glasgow.

It was a moment of immense pride for the 33-year-old as he recorded a mark of 21.07m and pipped one of his idols, New Zealand's Worlds and Olympic medallist Tom Walsh. Fresh from his CWG glory, Enekwechi, who hails from the Anambra State, lived up to his billing by securing the top place with 20.78m at the World Athletics Continental Tour Silver meet at the Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar.

During an interaction, he spoke about his journey, ambitions and his experience of competing in India.

How did you feel after becoming Nigeria's first shot putter to win gold at the Commonwealth Games?

It was amazing, especially at that moment. My life hasn't changed much, but it was a piece of history. It was a huge honour. Many people tried before me and came close. For me to be the first person in history, it's something that nobody can take away from me. And I made a lot of people proud and happy. That means the world to me.

You had clinched a silver in the 2018 CWG. What happened after that?

It was eight years ago. A lot can change in one year. I tried to get a medal in Birmingham (2022) but I didn't. I was fourth. The pressure doubled leading up to Glasgow. But I knew I had to stay consistent, work hard and take it extremely seriously. I prepared very well, but I was also a bit lucky to have that win. So I'm very grateful.

How did you get into shot put?

I just wanted to lift weights and I had to do something. I had to join a team to lift weights. So I joined athletics on a whim, and things just kept getting better and better.

What challenges do Nigerian throwers face?

It's mostly infrastructure issues. A lot of the attention goes towards sprints and events that already have funding from shoe companies. The throws (events) don't get much funding. That would make a big difference... some of it is like investing in coaching and facilities.

The other thing is that I've had a lot of international success. Maybe leaning into that, positioning me in a position where I can help out some of the young guys coming up. That would be a very big benefit for the nation.

Where do you train and how is the funding now?

Funding... it's not there. But I train in Lafayette, Indiana (USA). I went to school at Purdue University and that's where I train now. I moved there for schooling and after I graduated, I just stayed there and continued to train. I'm 10 years out of school, so I've been there for 15 years now.

What advice will you give to young Nigerian throwers?

Give yourself a chance because when you look at me, I'm not the biggest



thrower. I'm probably the shortest guy in the field: I'm 180 centimetres tall. And if you looked at me, especially before I put on a lot of muscle, you would not have thought of me as world-class or as a 22-metre shot putter. But I took a chance on myself and I was able to execute it. What it means is that many more kids can do what I did or even better.

Do you get the opportunity to go back to Nigeria?

Yeah, I go to Nigeria once or twice every year... for the National championships, for the sports festival. I take that opportunity to coach some of the local talent. Just kind of give them advice, give the coaches advice... just like there's so much support for the Indian talent. That's how I feel for

my countrymen. I want them to succeed just as much as anybody would for their country. I do as much as I can to help.

What's your next goal?

I would love to get another major medal and improve my personal best. I'm 33 years old now, but every year I seem to find something new to add to my repertoire. I just want to keep improving. Before I start to decline, I just want to be consistent at a high level.

Do you have anything specific in mind?

I want to keep making finals and compete for a medal at major championships. That would be awesome.

Who are your inspirations?

Some of the guys who are still competing. I looked up to Joe Kovacs for a long time. He's one of the throwers who's not the biggest but super powerful and consistent. I followed him and added my own stuff



One thing I can tell about India is that Indians are very proud of their culture. We had a good immersive experience — the music, meeting some of the dignitaries, the art styles, culture, food. This is my first time in India. New experiences are always welcome. I had a lot of fun.

to get to a world-class level.

And the funny thing is I'm like that for some younger throwers now. It's kind of full circle. Joe was a big inspiration for me... Reese Hoffa, Ryan Whiting and Adam Nelson. A lot of the guys who are still involved in the sport... even Walsh. We're not that different in terms of age, but he was achieving at such a high level when I was still in university. These guys are friends now. But I looked up to them and I kind of learned from them.

Have you made some Indian friends?

Yeah. I met two of the local guys. I've known Tajinderpal Singh Toor for years now. I just met Samardeep Gill in Glasgow. In shot put, we're all competitors but we're also colleagues. So there's always respect in the first place. I know the guys were cheering each other on in between rounds. Even though we compete hard, there's a lot of support within the group.

How was the experience of coming to India and competing here?

It was very nice. One thing I can tell about India is that Indians are very proud of their culture. We had a good immersive experience. The music, meeting some of the dignitaries, the art styles, culture, food. We were immersed in the culture. I've been at it for 10 years now. This is my first time in India. New experiences are always welcome. I had a lot of fun.



What two districts can teach us about dealing with rural waste

Worldwide, around 2.7 billion people do not have their waste collected, and of them 2 billion live in rural areas, an analysis by the UN Environment Programme has found; where people cannot manage waste, they dump it on land or in rivers, streams, and seas, or burn it, a major concern in India

Mahima Jain
MAJULI/BENGALURU

On April 30, 2025, Bibhash Bormedhi looked on as a tonne of waste left Majuli on a boat across the Brahmaputra river. “This was the first time the waste from Majuli crossed the Brahmaputra, instead of being dumped into the river,” Mr. Bormedhi, Project Manager at waste management non-profit Sahaas, which led the initiative, said.

On Independence Day 2024, in Arunachal Pradesh’s Tawang District, villagers from Zemithang Circle sent away 4.4 tonnes of garbage in a lorry. Nestled in the folds of the Himalaya, between 6,900 feet and 8,000 feet high, they had segregated their waste for the first time. The truck made a 390-km journey lasting over 12 hours to scrap dealers in Tezpur, Assam.

Behind these efforts lay months of preparation, creative ways of financing, and a growing awareness that waste was becoming a mounting problem in the remotest corners of India.

‘Data does not exist’

The country produces 1.7 lakh tonnes of waste every day, per the Central Pollution Control Board. Of this, 22% ends up in landfills and 17% is unaccounted for. Activists groups and experts have said data on rural waste are simply not counted at all.

“Waste data for rural areas doesn’t exist,” said Siddharth Singh, programme manager, Solid Waste Management and Circular Economy, Centre for Science and Environment (CSE), New Delhi. Urban and rural local bodies are tasked with solid waste management and data collection, including volumes and expenses, but they rarely do the needful, Mr. Singh added.

Earlier this month, the Supreme Court pulled up the Union and State governments for not institutionalising the Solid Waste Management Rules 2026. The court ordered that regulatory bodies must be notified, staffed, and provided with the necessary infrastructure to function effectively.

Data show a rise in per-capita spending in India’s rural areas. More consumption also results in more waste.

“Food, beverages, personal care or hygiene products – almost everything is wrapped in plastics or multi-layered packaging,” Mr. Singh said. “These goods have penetrated the remotest rural markets.”

Waste management has not, however. Worldwide, around 2.7 billion people do not have their waste collected – and of them 2 billion live in rural areas, an analysis by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) found.

Where people cannot manage waste, they dump it on land or in rivers, streams, and seas, or they burn it, which is a major concern in India.

“In Majuli, people used to throw the waste in their fields or in the river,” Brojen Pegu, a Majuli local, said. “When it flooded every year, the river carried the waste away.”

For centuries, organic waste was used to feed livestock or as manure. But more plastics and other non-biodegradable materials have led to a mixed waste today, which is harder to decompose.

Majuli’s method

Alakesh Gogoi, District Official, Swachh Bharat Mission and the Public Health Engineering Department, said his department built the Central Material Collection Facilities (CMCFs) in 19 of 20 panchayats and mini-collection facilities in most of the 160 villages between 2017 and 2022. However, neither were these tin sheds used nor were the workers mobilised. In 2024, Sahaas teamed up with the departments, he said.

A waste management system needs several other components besides CMCFs, according to Mr. Bormedhi.

Community participation goes hand-in-hand with operationalising collection and transportation.

Village leaders, homestay and hotel owners, schools and self-help groups participated in awareness programmes, and handed out bags for storage and segregation.

Simultaneously, the logistics of managing the non-biodegradable waste was fine-tuned, Mr. Bormedhi said.

This included funding, staffing, and training sanitation workers; arranging for vehicles for transport; operating the material collection facilities; and finding recyclers.



Women in Gobuk, Upper Siang, Arunachal Pradesh, gather for the monthly ‘Swachchata Divas’, a collection drive where the community brings and segregates its household waste. FURTHER AND BEYOND FOUNDATION/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Today, garbage is collected in 19 of 20 panchayats despite the locals facing floods and erosion, Mr. Gogoi said.

A community-led model

In the land-locked and mountainous villages of Tawang, there was no escape for garbage.

Having sanitation workers collect garbage from door to door wouldn’t work here because the settlements are scattered, Alifa Zibrani, senior project coordinator with Himalayan Fringes Project, Further and Beyond Foundation, a nonprofit focused on community-led waste management, said.

Instead, in 2024, through the Project, local officials and village leaders came together to pilot a community-led model of waste management in Chullyu in Keyi Panyor district. Within two years, the model had been adopted by a third of Tawang district and parts of Keyi Panyor and Upper Siang districts as well.

“Every household is responsible for segregating biodegradable and

Data show a rise in per-capita spending in India’s rural areas, which also results in more waste; experts said that while ‘food, beverages, personal care or hygiene products’, almost all of which are ‘wrapped in plastics’, have ‘penetrated the remotest rural markets’, waste management has not

are also smaller community-led MRFs in Chullyu and Gobuk in Upper Siang.

Here, 12 full-time MRF operators and dozens of women from self-help groups perform the secondary sorting, into 35 categories.

The locals also wash and dry sanitary napkins and diapers, which are also stored at MRFs. More than 20 tonnes have been sold to recyclers, generating a revenue of ₹3.53 lakh.



Villagers gather during a waste-collection drive in Taksang, Zemithang Circle, Tawang District. Taksang is 11,000 feet above the sea level. FURTHER AND BEYOND FOUNDATION/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

non-biodegradable waste. They store it in their homes. And then once a month, the community comes together and segregates the waste on a ‘collection day’,” Tashi Dondhup, additional deputy commissioner, Lumla Circle, which adopted the model as well, said.

“We don’t have any sanitation workers. Every village organises a collection day called *Swachchata Divas* (Cleanliness Day),” Ms. Zibrani said. A designated location in the village becomes the collection and sorting point, where “residents gather with sacks full of waste, and sort it into 22 categories. Some even clean the streets along the way.”

So far, 26 villages that are part of the project have organised more than 150 *Swachchata Divas* and collected 30 tonnes of waste. The waste is taken to material recovery facilities (MRF), sites in Zemithang, Lumla and Daporijo where it is received, sorted, and processed. There

Monthly fee
Per the UNEP, the most expensive step in the waste management chain is collection: in the form of crew wages, vehicle fuel and maintenance, insurance, and other indirect costs. A recent CSE report on plastic waste management, which Mr. Singh co-authored, also found that primary collection and transportation account for the bulk of costs in Indian cities.

The report examined the case of rural Dharamshala, where nearly 50% of the primary collection cost was attributed to manpower.

The Himalayan Fringes Project eliminated the costs associated with sanitation workers and door-to-door collection. And to keep the operations financially sustainable, the community has set up accountability and independent financing mechanisms. Specifically, each region has a central

committee chaired by a Circle Officer and a Lama (an influential religious leader) as secretary. At the village level, a *gaon bura* (village head) and a treasurer lead the committees that draft waste management policies, and set the rules, responsibilities, and fines. They meet every quarter.

Households are asked to pay a monthly fee of ₹50. Shops and cafes pay ₹100.

“Money is the biggest problem to run such a system,” Deewan Mara, former Zemithang Circle Officer, now officer and district magistrate, Daporijo, and a State Silver Medal winner for his work on managing waste, said.

First and last mile

Majuli’s 1.67 lakh people are served by 37 sanitation workers and 19 sorting staff.

Mridul Das, 38, from Silakola is one of them. Most people segregate their waste, he said. “But in every 100 households there may be 30 who still give mixed waste. They don’t listen.”

Recently, Mr. Gogoi’s department and the Panchayat and Rural Development Department purchased 21 e-vehicles – including the one Mr. Das drives – and 15 tricycles, and approved funds for the collection crew.

The transportation cost to recyclers is high in rural areas because the waste travels farther, Mr. Singh said, rendering the task less attractive for scrap dealers.

Ms. Zibrani said it costs ₹45,000 to send one truckload of waste from Arunachal Pradesh to Assam. Initially, the locals in Tawang volunteered their vehicles for collection. But over time, the project’s success drew the attention of Senior State government officials, who donated a truck. Yet the cost of fuel and driver is still Rs 20,000 per trip, she added. Apart from this, some two tonnes of multi-layered plastics were sent to a processing plant at Lhou in Jang sub-division, where it was used to make paver blocks, Mr. Dondhup said.

‘Show a way’

Between April 2025 and May 2026, Majuli transferred 16.78 tonnes of waste and earned ₹1.47 lakh. Mr. Bormedhi said there have been three boat transfers, which are expensive, so now Majuli sells its waste to local scrap dealers as well.

However, there have been no takers for black polythene and textile scrap, and Majuli’s long-defunct plastics management facility is undergoing repairs. Many CMCFs are also filling up quickly.

According to Mr. Singh, it is not uncommon to find rural collection facilities filled to the brim with baled waste, and with few takers. Mr. Bormedhi is not discouraged, however. Since 2024, Majuli has collected 82.4 tonnes of waste and thus prevented it from ending up in the Brahmaputra and the ocean, he said.

“All we are trying to do is to show a way. A model where rural waste management can work.”

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NASA astronaut evaluates the AstroRad vest onboard the International Space Station in 2022. 2S0CKZ (CC BY-SA)

AstroRad vest offers lighter shield against solar storms

Vasudevan Mukunth

Despite their best efforts to settle the moon and later Mars, humans may never become a spacefaring species, more than a few experts have said over the years. An important reason for this view is radiation. The earth has a magnetic field that keeps harmful radiation at bay, but astronauts who fly beyond this field are at risk of developing cancer and other serious health problems.

A common fix for this problem has been to add more shielding for astronauts. However, every additional kilogram increases the launch cost by a large amount, and it is often also impractical to add enough shielding to a crew capsule to cope with a major outburst of radiation from the sun.

To this end, an Israeli company named StemRad has, along with Lockheed Martin, developed a vest called AstroRad. StemRad had originally made the suit for emergency responders on the ground

Radiation remains a major obstacle to long duration human spaceflight because astronauts beyond earth’s magnetic field face increased risks of cancer and other health problems

who may be exposed to nuclear radiation. The company adapted it for spaceflight, with a twist: AstroRad has more safeguards over the chest, abdomen, and pelvis, where there are large amounts of bone marrow, which make blood, and sensitive organs like the heart and the lungs. It also uses hydrogen-rich polymers to block radiation – materials rich in hydrogen slow energetic particles efficiently because hydrogen nuclei are similar in mass and so maximise energy transfer during collisions – rather than lead, which is more dense.

In 2019 and 2020, NASA arranged for astronauts to test AstroRad onboard the International Space Station. They wore it as they performed ordinary activities and gave feedback on its comfort and functionalities, allowing engineers on the ground to make improvements.

NASA tested the improved version onboard its Artemis I mission in 2022. In this mission, the crew capsule carried two human-shaped dummies named Helga and Zohar as it travelled around the moon before returning to the earth. Both Helga and Zohar were fit with materials designed to mimic human tissue as well as radiation sensors. Zohar wrote AstroRad while Helga did not.

The results of analysing the data retrieved from the dummies were published in *Science Advances* on August 12. Using data collected during Artemis I to inform models of historical solar radiation events, researchers – from StemRad, Lockheed, the German, Israeli, and U.S. space agencies, and institutions in the U.S. – found AstroRad could reduce the effective radiation dose an astronaut would have received during the August 1972 solar storm by 60% and during the October 1989 solar storm by 40%. These amount to 193 and 131 fewer days, respectively of exposure to deep-space radiation.

Per the team, for astronauts heading back to the moon and eventually to Mars, AstroRad could allow astronauts to partially work through a solar storm instead of having to shelter themselves for the duration – a small but important step towards making interplanetary human spaceflight a safe reality.

That said, one particular shortcoming of the vest is that it can only deal with particles from the sun. Galactic cosmic rays that originate beyond the solar system remain harder to block.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount outlined for Semicon programme by government

1.27 in ₹ lakh crore. The government on Monday notified the ₹1.27-lakh-crore Semicon 2.0 programme, spelling out eligibility and incentives across the semiconductor value chain, including 40% fiscal support for silicon wafer fabs with a minimum investment of ₹20,000 crore, and sweeteners for chip design. PTI

Surplus liquidity in banking system at the end of August

5 in ₹ lakh crore. Surplus liquidity in the banking system surged to nearly ₹5 lakh crore at the end of August, its highest level in over four months, boosted by month-end government spending and robust foreign currency deposits. According to data compiled by PTI from the Reserve Bank of India, surplus system liquidity stood at ₹5.05 lakh crore as on August 30. PTI

Monthly stipend of medical interns in J&K that triggered strikes

12,300 in ₹. MBBS and BDS interns across medical colleges in Jammu and Kashmir went on an indefinite strike on Monday, protesting a monthly stipend of just ₹12,300 and demanding it be raised to 30,000. The protesting interns claimed that their stipend had remained unchanged for nearly seven years. PTI

Number of houses sanctioned by A.P. under PMAY-Urban 2.0

17,912 The Andhra Pradesh government on Monday sanctioned nearly 18,000 houses at a cost of about ₹448 crore under the PMAY-Urban 2.0. An official said the unit cost of each house is ₹2.5 lakh, of which 60% will be provided as assistance by the Centre and the remaining 40% by the State government. PTI

Value of Israel's defence export deal with Greece

3.5 in \$ billion. Israel signed a multi-billion-dollar weapons deal with Greece, as Israeli defence exports soar. Israel's Defence Ministry said the nearly €3 billion (\$3.5 billion) defence export deal, coined Achilles Shield, is one of the country's largest and includes a multilayered air defence system for Greece using Israeli technology. AP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The broken promise of right to work

The replacement of MGNREGA with the VB-GRAM G Act has weakened the rural right-to-work framework; restoring a meaningful right to work through adequate funding, living wages and stronger local institutions would advance constitutional aims while also supporting rural demand and economic growth

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rajendran Narayanan
Vijay Ram S.

In August 21, a three-judge Supreme Court Bench led by the Chief Justice of India dismissed a petition and sought a fresh one in a case on minimum wages in rural employment guarantee programmes. The Bench lauded MGNREGA's role in rural development. It probed whether the 'Right to Work' should be treated on par with Article 21, the fundamental right to life, sparking an important discussion on the constitutional foundations of this right.

A guarantee under strain

Despite its limited scope of only 100 days of work per rural household and chronic underfunding, the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) was the only law anchored in the core principle of the right to work. In December 2025, the Union government replaced MGNREGA with the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar & Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-GRAM G) Act, and its implementation began on July 1. About 3.44 crore households worked for about 44 crore person-days under MGNREGA in July and August, on average, over the previous five years (**Table 1**). There has been a 68% decrease in employment in July and August this year compared with the average of the preceding five years. Notwithstanding the proverbial 'teething issues', the dismantling of MGNREGA's demand-driven right-to-work framework and the disproportionate fiscal burden that the new law places on States are likely to be major factors behind the dramatic fall in employment under the VB-GRAM G Act.

The impact of taking away even this limited right to work is therefore palpable. Discussions around the recent Supreme Court observations on the right to work can be traced back to the Constituent Assembly debates.

While most members agreed that a right to work was vital, the debate rested on whether it should be a fundamental right or be part of the Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP). The DPSPs do not automatically constitute rights but are meant to serve as precepts for governments to formulate laws and policies. This became the basis of the differences in perspective.

Professor K.T. Shah had strongly advocated recognising the right to work as a fundamental right, arguing that the State needed a constitutional and positive legal mandate to guarantee socio-economic security to its citizens. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, among others, held that while the right to work was an essential goal, its immediate universal enforcement was not fiscally and institutionally viable in a newly independent India that had been hollowed out of its resources. The placement of the right within the Directive Principles, rather than among the fundamental rights, thus reflected a deliberate constitutionalism of aspiration, rather than an abandonment of the welfare ideal. As scholars Anjani Kapoor and Manu Bhagwan have written in their essay 'Ambedkar and the anti-isolation of Fellowship', "The constitution does not establish the nation, but rather provides the tools to help achieve it."

Therefore, Article 41 of the DPSP states: "The State shall, within the limits of its economic capacity and development,

A shrinking safety net

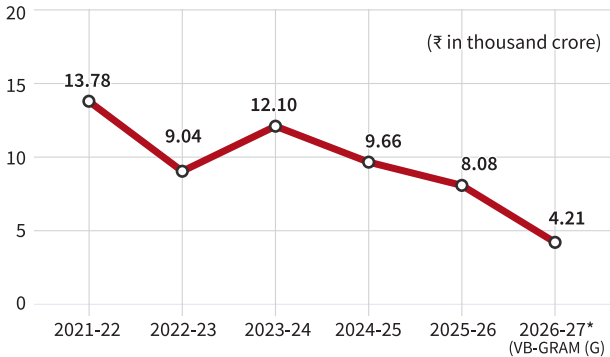
The shift from MGNREGA to VB-GRAM G has sharply reduced rural employment and earnings

Table 1: The number of households (HH) employed, person-days of work generated and average daily wages paid in July and August

Financial year	HH provided employment (in crore)	Persondays of work generated (in crore)	Average daily wage paid in July & August (₹)
2021-22	4.79	65.74	210
2022-23	3.13	40.14	225.5
2023-24	3.82	49.13	246.5
2024-25	3.04	37.36	259
2025-26	2.44	29.78	272
2026-27* (VB-GRAM G)	1.39	14.94	282.5

Sources: MGNREGA and VB-GRAM G MIS reports.
*Data as on 31st August 2026 for FY 2026-27.

Figure 1: Estimated household earnings in July and August



*Data as on 31st Aug 2026 | Note: Total household earnings = sum of average wage rate paid x persondays of work generated in July and August

Sources: MGNREGA and VB-GRAM G MIS reports.



make effective provision for securing the right to work..." Embodying stronger progressive consecrations, Articles 39, 42 and 43 call for the "right to an adequate means of livelihood, equal pay for equal work for both men and women, just and humane conditions of work" and to "secure to all workers a living wage and decent standard of life."

From aspiration to a statutory right

The Supreme Court, in *Olga Tellis vs Bombay Municipal Corporation* (1985), ruled that the right to livelihood was a necessary condition for the fundamental right to life, giving a judicial fillip to the right to work. Spurred by the collective efforts of activists and rural workers, the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act was passed in 2005. Although limited in scope, it made a pan-India right-to-work law a reality for the first time. The State had to ensure its statutory obligation to provide employment at minimum wages.

In 2009, MGNREGA wages were delinked from the Minimum Wages Act, 1948. Over time, MGNREGA wages barely kept pace with inflation and continued to remain lower than the minimum agricultural wages in most States. Low wages and an inadequate budget for generating employment have resulted in a steep decline in household earnings, with estimated total household earnings halving in July and August this year compared with the same months last year (**Figure 1**).

During the recent hearing, the Supreme Court Bench remarked that if financial resources remained the same, having a minimum wage threshold could reduce the number of workers who could

be provided employment. This remark, which appears to align with the Union government's approach to employment guarantee, merits scrutiny on at least two counts.

First, it vitiates the judgment in *Sanjit Roy vs State of Rajasthan* (1983) where the Supreme Court observed that payment of wages below minimum wages violates Article 23 of the Constitution and is akin to 'forced labour.' Second, it rests on a misleading economic logic that financial resources to implement a welfare programme must remain unchanged and constrained.

In reality, higher wages for rural workers increase their purchasing power, enhance their freedoms, and improve human development outcomes. These, in turn, increase effective demand for goods and services, creating a positive multiplier effect, resulting in higher economic productivity. Therefore, higher government spending on an employment guarantee programme at increased wages can yield a mutually reinforcing cycle between development and growth.

A retreat from the right to work

By putting an arbitrary cap on funds for the VB-GRAM G Act and not linking it with minimum wages, the very notion of employment guarantee stands delegitimised. States are already grappling with fiscal constraints and curtailed borrowing limits under the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) framework. The increased burden of funding the VB-GRAM G Act will prevent States from generating employment. The sharp drop in employment and earnings is a reflection of this change.

The VB-GRAM G Act also contains provisions to denotify certain areas and exclude them from the scheme, thereby limiting the universality of MGNREGA's right to work.

Lawyer Purbayan Chakraborty highlights how the Supreme Court has affirmed the doctrine of non-retrogression in *Navtej Singh Johar vs Union of India*. The doctrine implies that once the State has achieved a certain level of progressive legislation and enforceability of a right, it cannot implement measures that deliberately undo it. Non-retrogression operates as a check on State power, ensuring that rights, once realised, are not diluted later. The replacement of MGNREGA with the VB-GRAM G Act appears to be in violation of this doctrine.

Rural wages have been stagnant for a decade, while women are increasingly employed as 'unpaid family workers'. In such light, the minimal requirements for affirming the commitment to the right to work are: linking MGNREGA wages to living wages, timely payment of wages, a focus on social audits by empowering local institutions to be partners in mitigating corruption, and giving more powers to Panchayati Raj institutions.

All these measures could be implemented within a legal framework of the right to work. The VB-GRAMG Act, unfortunately, is silent on most of them. Reinstating the right to work would therefore not only be a legal course correction advancing constitutional aims, but would also be sound economics. (The authors are affiliated with the Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. The views expressed are personal)

THE GIST

▼ The Supreme Court's recent observations have revived the Constituent Assembly-era debate over whether the right to work should be a fundamental right or remain under the directive principles

▼ Keeping employment guarantee budgets constrained and wages below minimum wages can undermine both the constitutional promise of the right to work and rural household earnings

▼ Higher wages and greater public spending on employment can boost workers' purchasing power, stimulate demand for goods and services, and support wider economic growth

